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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

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| FRONT LINE | 21/8/18 | | The enemy's retaliation was very slight but all his shells contained mustard fumes which were very trying. The 2nd Cdn Bde got all their objectives. The remainder of the day was quiet on our front. During the afternoon it was arranged for Nos 3 & 4 Coys to capture HAMLINCOURT with the aid of 8 tanks but this was cancelled again. | |
| do. | 22/8/18 | | Bde remained as it was the previous day. Patrols were sent out from No 2 Coy. front and one patrol under 2/Lt. FARRADAY worked up HAMEL SWITCH as far as S. 30. a. 0.6. & there found was unable to proceed further owing to M.G. fire from Sunk road in S. 30. a. 2-6. from HAMLINCOURT and from the left. The patrol captured 4 Germans in getting there. They remained out some hours & a platoon was pushed across into HAMEL SWITCH to support them but a withdrawal was ordered as HAMLINCOURT was to be attacked next day. 2/Lt. FARRADAY'S patrol remained out to cover their withdrawal & the Germans after severe M.G. fire & rifle grenades attempted to cut them off. It was impossible to render them any assistance from our front line as they were over the ridge out of sight. They withdrew, keeping the enemy at bay and eventually the Lewis gun was knocked out and 5 men wounded. While these were being withdrawn 2/Lt Farraday - Sgt. P. DOLAN & Pte TAIT covered their retreat. It was very difficult as the enemy were only | |

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| | 22/8/18 | | Knee deep and filled in places with wire which they had to get over. In other places the French did not exist. 2/Lt. Farnaby was wounded early in the foot getting over some wire and then Sgt. DOLAN and Pte TAIT carried him in turn while the other threw German bombs at the enemy who were attempting to close with them. Eventually they got in sight of a covering party sent out to help them & the 3 got back. | |
| | 23/8/18 | | The Bde was withdrawn at 4. am the troops taking over a totally new position. The 2nd Gds. Bde moved to their left a little & the 58th Div on our ~~right~~ left moving a little to their right. While the Bde was withdrawing HAMLINCOURT was attacked & captured. The Bde marched back to BERLES-au-Bois, a march of over 12,000 yds, where they arrived tired after 7 days in front line. | |
| | 24/8/18 | | At 9. am the Bde marched back to BOIRY St MARTIN again and spent the day in the COJEUL Valley in Square 20 a. In the evening at 6.pm it moved into our old front line trenches in S. 26. d. | |

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| SUPPORT. Between HAMLINCOURT & ST LEGER. | 25/8/18. | | At midday parties were sent on from each coy to reconnoitre the way to advd Bde H.Q at St. T. 25. c. 8.3. At 5. pm. the Bn moved up into Support a Nos 2, 3 & 4 Coys were in HAMEL SWITCH along dividing line between Squares S. 30. c & d, No 2 Coy was in trench in B. 1. a. & Bn H.Q in HAMEL SWITCH in A. 6. b 5.5. The night which was wet was spent in above positions. The line made whilst shelling was comparatively slight. | MAP ERVILLERS ED. 1a (Loos) 1/20,000 |
| | 26/8/18. | | During the afternoon the Bn moved forward & was disposed as follows:- No 1 Coy JEWEL TR in B. 8. a & c Nos 3 & 4 Coys in HAMEL SWITCH from SENSEE VALLEY to junction of trenches in B. 1. d. 6.7. No 2 Coy remaining where it was and Bn Hd shared an old German dug out at B. 2. d. 5.3. with centre group artillery H.Q. The trenches occupied by the coys were only trenches in name having no shelter being only waist deep. | |
| | 27/8/18. | | At 1.30 am operation orders were received for an attack advance on ECOUST until opposition was met. A warning order had been sent earlier in the night. The 2nd Bn G. Gds on right and 2nd Bn C. Gds on left were leading Bdes this Bn following in Res. with 2 Coys (No 1 + 3) in depth following 2nd Bn G. Gds & Nos 4 + 2 Coys (in depth) following 2nd Bn C. Gds. ZERO hour was fixed for 7. a.m. The troops in our left Bde were not to attack CROISILLES until 3 hours later. | |

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| Support between HAMELINCOURT and ST LEGER. | 27/8/18 | | To gain touch with the Bde they were supporting the leading coys of each flank I.s. Nos 1 & 4 coys left their trenches at 5.45 am. The formation being as series it was decided that Bde should move along as far as possible the dividing line between leading Bns i.s. by MORY SWITCH and HALLY AVENUE. To take each coy. in detail. No 1 Coy. left JEWEL TR. at 5.45 am in Artillery formation of platoons in Diamond formation, going in an Easterly direction so as to leave ISCARIOT WORK on their left, and passed the jumping off point MORY SWITCH about point B.9.d.6.4. No 2 platoon led the company under Lt J. N. WARD. with orders to get in touch with 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds. at about this point and advance at about 400 yards behind them. Very shortly after Zero hour before the coy reached MORY SWITCH the enemy put down a very heavy barrage on MORY SWITCH and the wire to the EAST of it through which they had to pass. Almost the first two shells obtained direct hits on platoons and made casualties of Lt J N WARD and Lt P.S. MACMAHON. The Company suffered heavily under the barrage, but continued to follow the reserve coy. of the 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds., who were if anything bearing a little to the South. When the leading platoon had reached the point B.10.d.7.2. Capt. THOMPSON, M.C. the coy. commander observed that the 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds were lying down. Capt. THOMPSON ordered his coy. to do the same owing to M.G. | |

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| | 27/28 -8-18 | | fire which appeared to be coming from both flanks. He went up to the Coy. Comdr. of the Reserve Coy. 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds to find out what had happened and was informed that they were held up by enemy M.G. fire. No 1 Coy waited here some time hoping that the 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds would be able to advance with the help of 4 M.Gs which were working up on Right flank and attempting to silence enemy M.G. fire. Finally at about 10.30 a.m. Captain THOMPSON realized that the leading battalion could not advance & seemed unlikely to be able to do so owing to their heavy casualties. He therefore ordered the Company to dig in as a Support line, making 2 posts about the points B. 10. d. 8. 1. & B. 10. d. 7. 3. No 1 platoon was withdrawn for the night and dug in in support at about B. 10. d. 5. 1. | |
| | | | During the whole day the stretcher-bearers of No 1 Coy had done excellent work under heavy M.G. fire, in recovering casualties not only of this battalion but also of the 2nd Bn. Grenadier Guards and 4th Bn M.G. Gds | |
| | | | On the night of the 27th No 1 Coy was ordered to hand over its posts to the 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds and to form a support line along the road through B. 10. d. This relief was completed about 12.30 a.m 28th and the company occupied the road from about B. 10. d. 2.0. to B. 10. d. 3. 6. | |
| | | | About 11 a.m. on the 28th the O.C. 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds informed Capt. | |

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| | 27/28 -8-18 | | THOMPSON that his battalion would occupy BANKS TRENCH and that No 1 Coy. was to fill the gap on the left of the 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds. from about B.11.a.0.15 to where it could get in touch with the rest of the 1st Bn Irish Gds on the left. If possible No 1 Coy was ordered to push on and occupy BANKS RESERVE. Capt. THOMPSON advanced his coy. as ordered and was in position about 12.15 p.m. Patols were at once sent forward to search BANKS WOOD (B.11.a. and b), the Camouflage in B.11.a. and the Sunken road which runs through B.11.b. and strikes BANKS RESERVE at B.5.d.3.1. The ground was found to be all clear, and the company advanced and occupied BANKS RESERVE TRENCH from B.5.d.3.1. to B.11.b.8.6.; No 3 platoon forming a covering up party. On arrival at BANKS RESERVE, a L.G. post was established at the cross Roads B.5.d.5.8. and patols were sent forward along track running from B.5.d.5.8 through B.6.c. and d. A patol was also sent to reconnoitre open ground in front of BANKS RESERVE. No ~~enemy~~ opposition was met with and BANKS RESERVE was in a state of defence by 1.15.p.m. | |
| | | | About 2.p.m touch was obtained with Nos 2 & 4 Coys at B.5.d.3.1, | |

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| | 27/28-8-18 | | and No 1 Coy handed over their left posts and occupied BANKS RESERVE from B. 11. b. 6. 7. to B. 11. b. 10. 3. where touch was obtained with 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds who arrived at about 2. p. m.<br>No further incident occurred until the Coy. was relieved at about 11.30 p.m. by 2 platoons of the 1st Bn. GORDON HIGHLANDERS. | |

No 3 Coy. followed in rear of No 1 Company in Artillery formation, 400 yards in rear of No 1 Coy and 200 yards between platoons. The barrage fell equally heavily on this company as on the others. The Coy. Commdr. Capt. W. JOYCE, was wounded and Lt H.R. BALDWIN killed at an early stage in the attack. 2/Lt HEATON took over command of the Coy. The company halted behind the 2nd Bn. Grenadier Guards and consolidated a line, echeloned slightly to the right rear. The company did not move forward again but remained in support. 2/Lt HEATON was wounded (gassed) at about 4. p.m. and A/C.S.M. O'HARE took over command.

On the morning of August 28th the company was put under the orders of O.C. 2nd Bn. Grenadier Guards.

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| | 27/28-8-18 | | No 4 Coy. at 6.45 a.m. left their trench in support to the 2nd Bn Coldstream Gds. Crossing the SENSÉE VALLEY, they followed the line of MORY SWITCH and crossed the road at B.8.a.5.9 at 7.5 a.m. His company got the most intense barrage of any. They started in Artillery formation of platoons and on crossing the road they divided again into half platoons. On reaching the sunken road running in B. 4. b and d. they found that the 2nd Bn Coldstream Guards, ~~about~~ held up by M.G. fire about 50 yards from their starting point (the sunken road in B. 4. b. and d.) and unable to advance. They had suffered very heavy casualties from M.G. fire at close range from both flanks.<br>Capt. HEGARTY, in command of No 4 Coy. ordered ~~platoon~~ No 14 platoon under 2/Lt HUTCHINSON to reinforce the 2nd Bn. Coldstream Gds. and to dig in on about the line B.4.d.6.7. to B.4.b.7.1. No 13 platoon formed a defensive flank together with the remains of No. 15 platoon, at about B. 4.d.6.6. 2/Lt CONNOLLY was in command but was wounded almost at once by M.G. fire. No 16 platoon was kept in Reserve with Coy. H.Q. in the sunken road B.4.d.4.8.<br>At about 8. p.m. Capt. HEGARTY was ordered by O.C. Batt'n to send forward 1 platoon to reconnoitre and make good BANKS TRENCH, from which a large number of prisoners had just given themselves up. No 14 platoon was ordered to do this and they made good BANKS TRENCH as far as B.10.b.5.8. | |

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| | 27/28 -8-18 | | and got into touch with No 2 Coy ~~in~~ ST LEGER RESERVE at about B. 4. d. 7. 7.<br>On account of the shortage of men No 14 platoon, (less 1 section left to protect the right of No 2 Coy in BANKS TRENCH.) was withdrawn to their original line which they had dug in B. 4. d and b.<br>There is nothing further to report until about noon on August 28th when owing to rumours of enemy withdrawal Capt HEGARTY was ordered to push forward patrols. Sgt REGAN and 8 O.R. advanced to the boundary line between B. 5. d & B 6 c. Here found they found to be unoccupied. Capt HEGARTY then pushed forward (No 13 & 16 platoons) to the Sunken Road, which runs from about B. 5 d 3. 0. to B. 5. ~~[illegible]~~ d. 4. 8, starting at about 1.30 p.m. 28th<br>At about 4.30 p.m. this 2 platoons were relieved by 2 platoons of No 2 Coy and returned to B. 4 d. 4. 8.<br>These platoons were maintained until the Battalion was relieved<br>No 4 Coy was relieved by the Kirkcudbrights ~~[illegible]~~ in position<br>could not take over as the ~~[illegible]~~ Coy ~~[illegible]~~ was sent to the rear<br>No 4 Coy Capt B. 4 d. 4. 8 and proceeded to Bivouac | |

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| | 27/28-8-18 | | No 2 Coy under the command of Capt A. PAGET left its trenches at 6.45 a.m. on the morning of the 27th August They followed No 4 Coy in artillery formation of platoons. The company crossed the ST LEGER — VRAUCOURT road to the left of the Crucifix at B.4.b.2.1. and extended on reaching the ST LEGER — LONGATTE road with the company facing due EAST. After clearing ST LEGER WOOD the company doubled across the open into ST LEGER RESERVE trench in B.5.a. and held from LONGATTE Road inclusive on the right to the junction of ST LEGER and BANKS ~~trench~~ RESERVE trenches on the left. At this time Captain PAGET was in ignorance of the location or success of the attacking battalions and both his flanks were exposed as far as he knew.<br>No 8 platoon, under 2/Lt MATHIESON had not reached the trench at this time, and had lost touch.<br>About 9.30 a.m. 2/Lt ATKINSON 2nd Bn. Coldstream Gds came to the trench and informed O.C. No 2 Coy of the general situation and the necessity for forming a defensive flank to protect the EASTERN side of ST LEGER, for which purpose 1 section was detached from No 5 platoon. A few stragglers from 2nd Bn. Coldstream Gds. who had attached themselves to No 2 Coy were sent to strengthen the defensive flank. | |

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| | 27/28-8-18 | | At about 11.30 a.m. a message was received from O.C. No 4 Coy. Irish Guards saying that he was on the ST LEGER — VRAUCOURT Road in B.4.d. Capt. PAGET went to No 4 Coy. H.Q. to clear up the situation. He also saw O.C. 2nd Bn Coldstream Guards and explained his dispositions to him. On the way he found No 8 platoon under 2/Lt MATHIESON and ordered him to report to Lt HARVEY M.C., which he did with a party of Coldstream 9ds under a sergt. sent to him by O.C. 2nd Bn. C.Gds. Lt HARVEY then organized this party on the left of No 2 Coy. | |
| | | | About this time the enemy was observed coming up in threes and fours and forming up under cover of the ridge parallel to and 100 yards East of ST LEGER RESERVE. In a few minutes the enemy advanced in line, extended at about 3 paces, to within 60 yards of No 2 Coy. Fire was opened on them with L.Gs, rifles and an enemy M.G. and considerable casualties were inflicted. The attempt to occupy ST LEGER RESERVE Trench was completely broken up. From then onwards parties of the enemy were seen retiring over the ECOUST — MORY Ridge, some of these were dispersed by long range fire from No 2 Coy., enemy rifles and S.A.A. being used to save our own. | |
| | | | At 6.30 p.m., as some enemy were still in BANKS TRENCH on the right flank of No 2 Coy. arrangements were made by O.C. Battalion to clear it by Artillery fire. A barrage of 18 pdrs. was put on to it, for 10 minutes at 7. p.m. At 7.10 p.m 1 Sgt and 8 O.R. | |

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| | 27/28-8-18 | | were to cross the road and mop up any enemy remaining. Almost before they had time to do so, no less than 70 of the enemy hoisted the white flag and were captured. The trench was then occupied by posts, assisted by a platoon of No 4 Coy. under 2/Lt HUTCHINSON.<br>The night of August 27/28th was fairly quiet except for some heavy shelling of ST LEGER RESERVE and BANKS TRENCH. No 2 Coy's casualties during the night being 2 killed and 6 wounded.<br>On August 28th few signs of enemy movement were observed. BANKS RESERVE was patrolled as far ~~as~~ as the ST.LEGER – LONGATTE Road, and no trace of the enemy was found. On this being reported O.C. Bn. No 2 Coy was ordered to patrol the ST LEGER-LONGATTE Road to and including the triangular cross roads in B. 5. d. On meeting with no opposition orders were received to advance and take up a position with the left of the coy. resting at the road junction at B. 5. b. 45. 0. and the right in touch with Nos 4 and 1 Coys Irish Guards ~~and~~ at about B. 5. d. 3. 1. Two platoons were in support astride the ST.LEGER-LONGATTE Road. This was at about 2. p. m.<br>Patrols were next sent out to reconnoitre along the ÉCOUST Road for about 1500 yards and along a frontage of 500 yards. They met with no opposition but enemy were seen on the high ground between LONGATTE and VRAUCOURT<br>No 2 Coy's new position was heavily shelled at intervals until its relief by a coy. of the KINGS OWN. at about 11 p. m. | |

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| | 27/28 -8-18 | | Battalion H.Q. left their overnight H.Q. in the SENSÉE VALLEY at about 6.40 a.m. on the morning of the 27th and reached the point where MORY SWITCH crosses road at B.8.a.5.9. a few minutes before 7 a.m.<br>After No. 4 Coy had gone by, the C.O. stopped No. 2 Coy for about 5 minutes hoping that the intense barrage which was falling along the line B.2.d. and B.8.b. would lighten a bit. This as a matter of fact occurred and No. 2 Coy got through before it again became intense<br>Bn. H.Q. moved up along HALLY AVENUE a waist deep trench, but was unable to proceed beyond the point B.10.a.5.9. owing to intense M.G. fire<br>The C.O. after going over to the right and getting in touch with the 2nd Bn. Grenadier Guards tried to make battalion H.Q. at HALLY COPSE. This however proved to be in the front line, as there was a Sap between the leading Battalions and the enemy were still holding BANKS TRENCH with a M.G. firing from about B.4.d.6.0. Going from shell hole to shell hole Bn. H.Q. gained HALLY AVENUE with only 2 casualties and H.Q. were established at the junction of HALLY AVENUE and MORY SWITCH at B.9.b.0.5<br>At about 1.30 p.m. a rear Bn. H.Q. was formed here and the C.O. and Adjutant and a few orderlies formed forward H.Q. in the sunken road at B.4.d.4.8. with 2nd Bn. Coldstream Guards. The line at this time | |

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| EAST of ST LEGER | 28/8/18 | | running roughly for the 1st Bn Irish Guards from junction of LEDGER RESERVE and BANKS RESERVE on left, to B.4.d.6.6., then a gap without troops of any sort until the left of No 1 Coy (with 2nd Bn. G. Gds.) was reached at about B.10.d.7.3. [The 2nd Bn G. Gds. were in front and perhaps a little to the left of this point]. | |
| | | | On the 28th the whole of Bn. H.Q. was moved up to SUNKEN ROAD at B.4.d.4.8. (The "ST. LEGER TREES") | |
| | | | --- --- | |
| | | | On the night of the 28th August the Battalion was relieved:- | |
| | | | No 1 Coy by 1st Bn GORDONS } 3rd Division | |
| | | | No 2 & 4 Coys " KINGS OWN } | |
| | | | No 3 Coy Under Orders of 2nd Bn. Grenadier Guards. | |
| SUPPORT between ST LEGER and HAMLINCOURT from Front line EAST of ST LEGER | 28/8/18 | | The Battalion marched back to the positions occupied before the morning of August 27th. Batt'n H.Q. in SENSÉE VALLEY. | |

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| AREA 'A' ADINFER WOOD | 29/8/18 | | On the morning of the 29th the battalion received orders to march to Area 'A' 'EAST of ADINFER'. The leading coy. passed cross Roads in T. 25. c. 8. 4. at 11.30 a.m. The battalion marched by Coys at 200 yards interval until the point S. 27. d. was reached where a halt was made for dinners from 1 p.m – 2.30 p.m. At 2.30 p.m the battalion marched in Column of Route via SUGAR FACTORY in X 24. a. to ADINFER where guides ~~met~~ were met and coys led to bivouacs in the PURPLE TRENCH SYSTEM in X. 27. c. and F. 3. a. | |
| AREA 'A' ADINFER WOOD | 30/8/18 | | During 30th the usual inspections took place but nothing further was done as the men were tired | |
| | 31/8/18 | | Details moved up to the battalion. Baths for the whole battalion at Divisional Baths ADINFER. | |

Rowel Baggallay
Lieut. Col.
Cmdg 1st Bn Irish Gds.
12-IX-18

D. D. & L., London, E.C.
(A10266) Wt W5300/P713 750,000 2/18 Sch. 52 Forms/C2118/16

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

APPENDIX 'B'

NARRATIVE OF OPERATIONS.

Night 4/5th August 1918

An enemy post having been located at S.24.a.50.35 during the day of 3rd August it was decided to ascertain its exact nature & strength on the night 3/4th and, if possible, raid it. Accordingly L/Cpl.MOHIDE & Pte. COLLETT left our trenches at 10 p.m. on 3rd at about S.23.b.95.55 and worked across the valley & right up to the post. This they found tenanted by what they estimated to be about 6 Germans and a machine gun. The Germans were quite unconscious of the presence of the patrol & were humming and talking. There was no wire in front of the post. The patrol got back to our lines at 12.15 a.m. and it was at once decided to send out a patrol of 1 Officer & 6 O.R. to raid the post. This second patrol had been held in readiness & were ready to start. Just as they were going some heavy guns of ours began dropping shells in our own wire and between it and the post to be raided. The shells appeared to be from a 60-pdr gun. As this had happened further to our right earlier on the same evening the Commanding Officer who was present decided not to let the patrol go as it was too dangerous with our artillery firing so short. The shells were coming from direction of BLAIREVILLE.

It was decided to raid the same post the following night. The post was carefully watched during the day & appeared to be occupied. At 10 p.m. night 4/5th the patrol consisting of Lieut. VERNON, L/Cpl.MOHIDE and 6 O.R. started out. They were dressed in special "crawling" suits and were armed with 4 revolvers & the remainder rifles.

They followed the same route as the scouts had used the previous evening (Route shownon attached map).

Crawling carefully down the valley they were unobserved until about 20 yards from the post. Here it is necessary to describe the ground. The grass which is long and tangled on our side of the valley becomes quite short just before coming to the road which runs below the bank on which the Six Trees are situated. The road itself drying stone white whereas previously it had been wet & dark. The plan was to crawl up to the bank & ascertain if trench marked "c" on sketch map was occupied and if not to come in on the post at "B" from the rear. The patrol were in snake formation and the leader crawled across the road & Lieut. VERNON after about 1 min. interval commenced to crawl across. As he did so a German sentry lying in the edge of the long grass at "A" challenged him then jumping up rushed up the bank firing 1 shot as he went. The patrol remained quiet, but the Germans were evidently ready because at once a party ran along the trees (d) apparently to cut the patrol off and fired down on them from the top of the bank; the M.G. opened fire wide of the patrol & a German threw bombs from "E" in the wrong direction. This all happened immediately on the sentry giving the alarm & some one in command gave short decisive orders. Very lights went up & knowing they were discovered & not being certain of what they might charge into the patrol retired. Also casualties would have been certain & very difficult to get back over so long a distance & wire.

Probable reasons of failure to Surprise Post.

(1). Not being able to continue the enterprise the night before when the Germans were not alert.

(2). The Germans must have seen during day the tracks in the long grass in the valley & on the bank made by the Scouts crushing it down when crawling the night before up to the post.

(3). Having seen the tracks & suspecting a raid the Germans were very alert - had a sentry out in front & had a plan of action already decided on. This latter was very obvious.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

(4). No Very Lights were sent up from the post but the moment the alarm was given Very Lights fired from post S. of it, all fell concentrated in front of the post where our patrol lay.

(5). Having been shelled the night before the garrison may have been more ~~alter~~ alert suspecting something.

Information.

(1). The post appears to be garrisoned by a M.G. (heavy) and 5 or 6 men in addition.

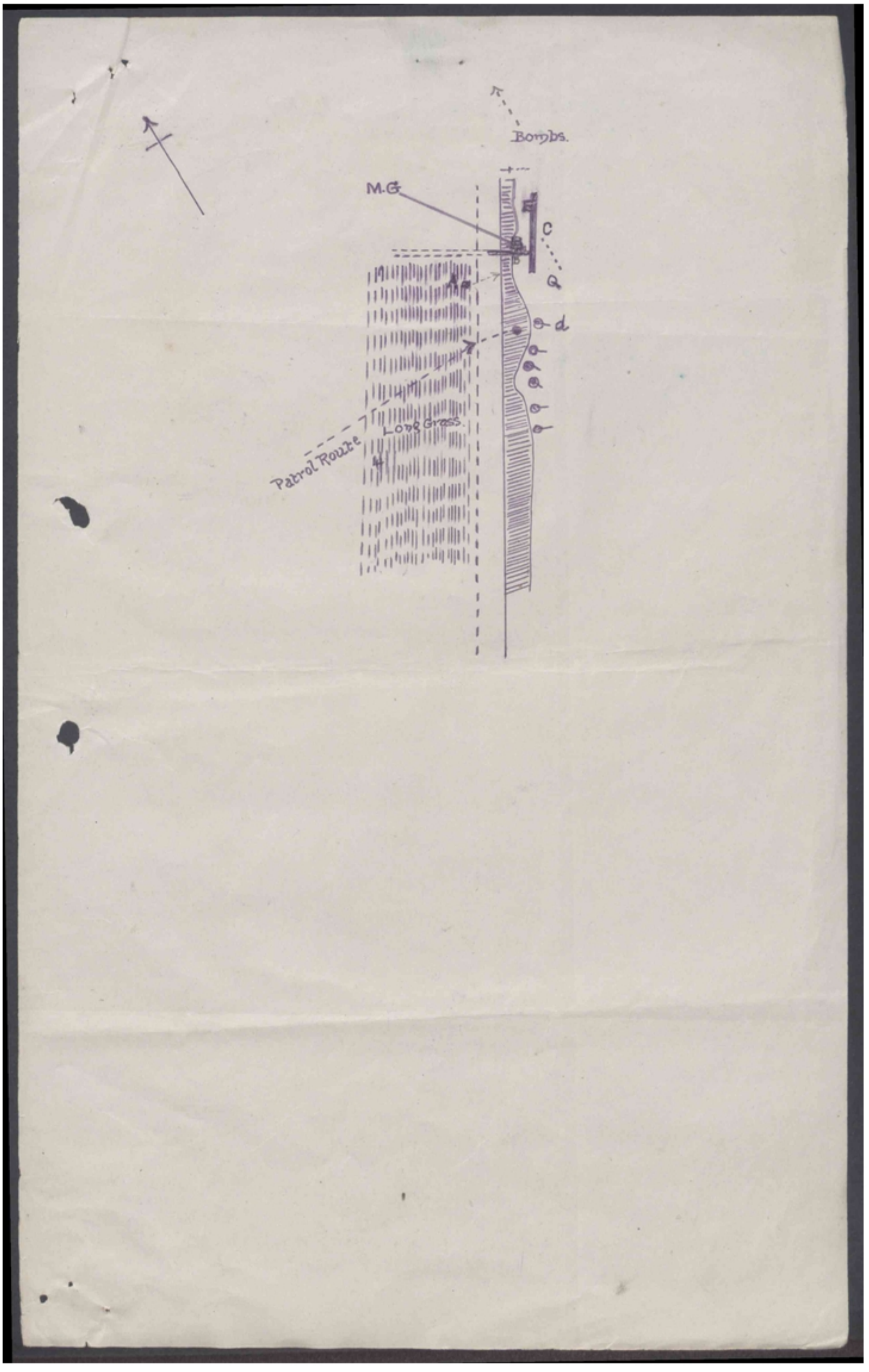
(2). The M.G. is probably meant to be a silent one as it has never fired before and it is very cleverly hidden firing from inside a framework in the bank the woodwork being painted green and the aperture covered with a sod by day (this information was obtained by previous observation).

Casualties.

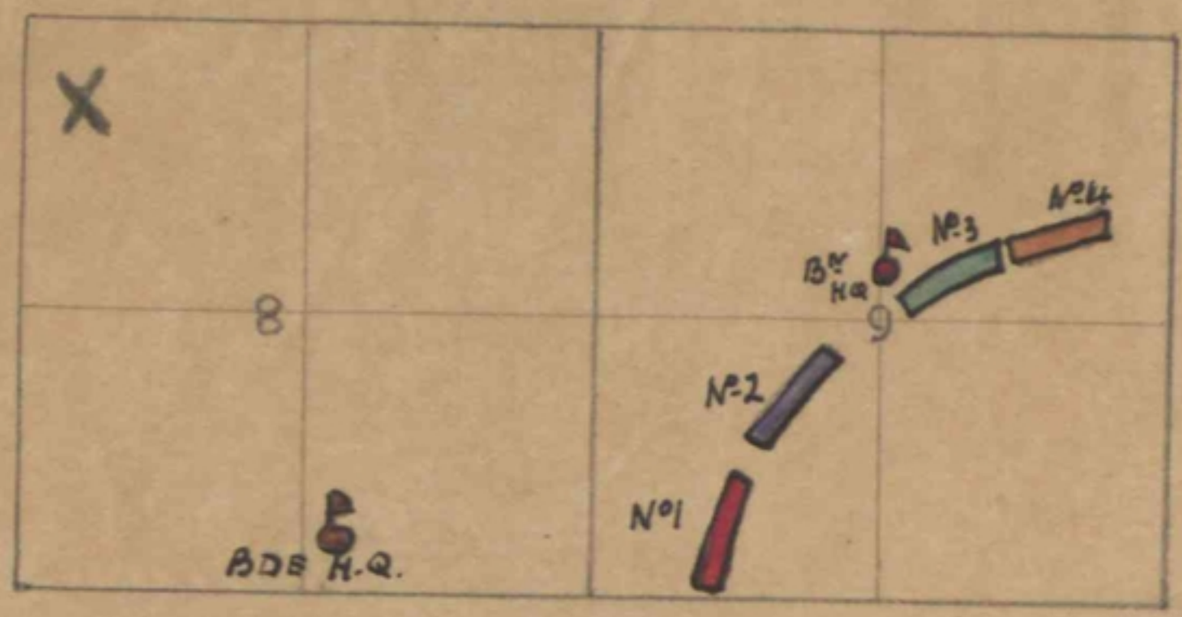
NIL.

Richard Baggallay
Lieut-Col.
Cmdg. 1st Bn. Irish Guards
6-VIII-18

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1



The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1




APPENDIX 'D'

To Superimpose map

AYETTE

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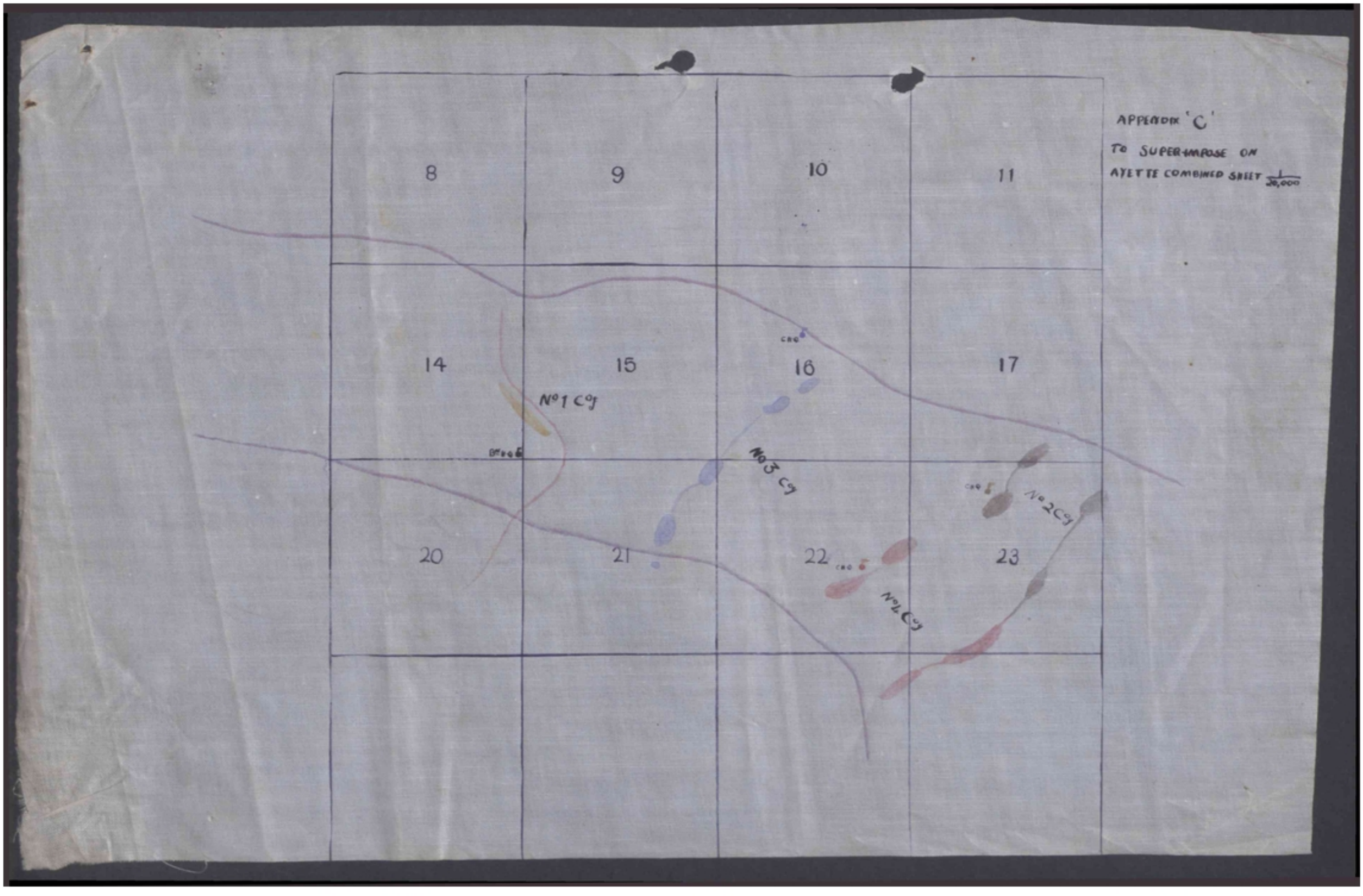
20,000.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1



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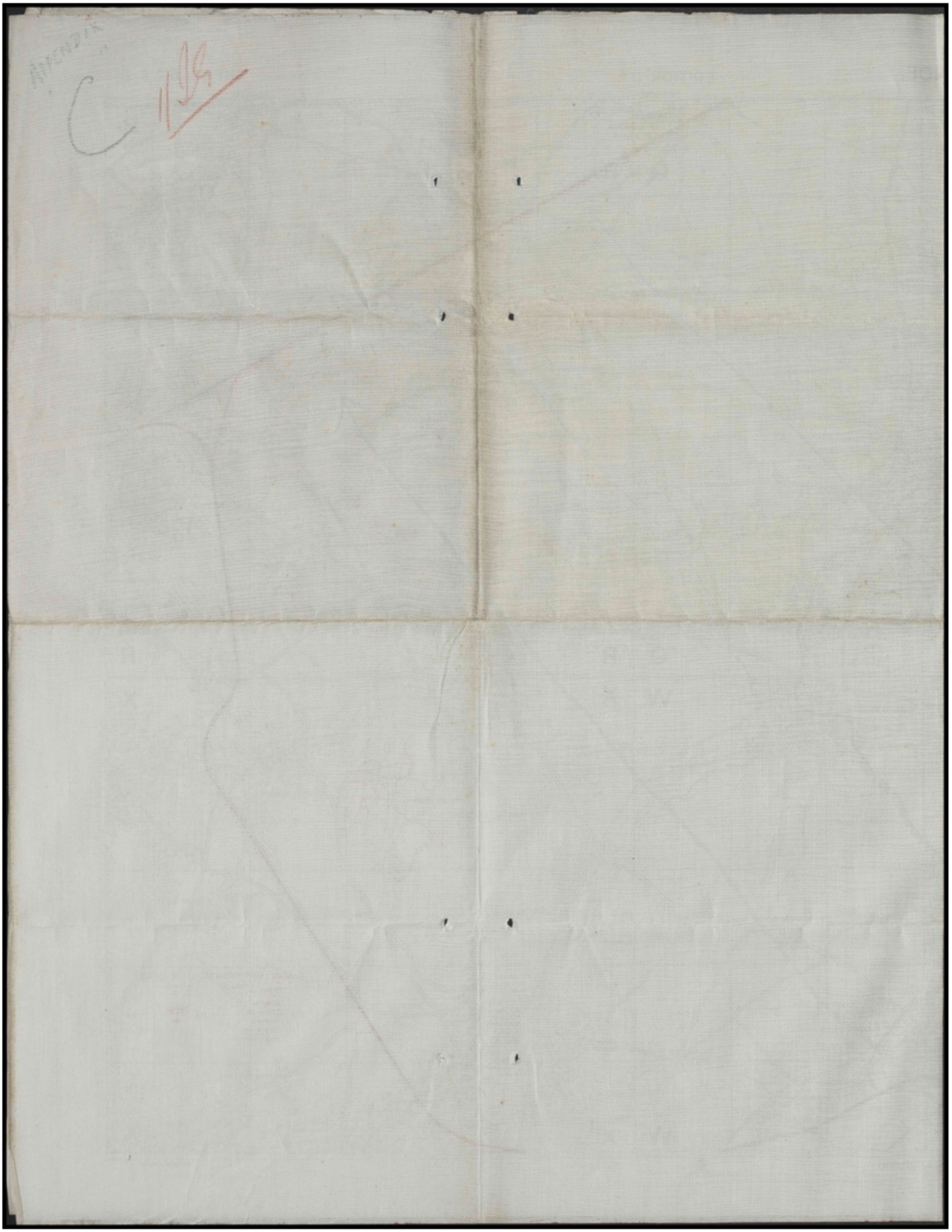

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APPENDIX
D

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

APPENDIX
"
D
11th Irish
Guards

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

APPENDIX A
11th Hussars

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

Copy No.....9.....

1st BATTALION IRISH GUARDS.

ADMINISTRATIVE ORDERS.

26th September 1918.

(1). TRANSPORT.

Lewis Gun Limbers & H.Q.Limber will report to Coy. & Battn.H.Q. at a time to be notified later, probably about 8 p.m. for Nos.1 & 4 Coys.& Battn.H.Q. For No.3 Coy. about 10 p.m. No.2 Coy. about 10 p.m. Lewis Guns will be loaded on them and 1 Lewis Gunner per Section will accompany Limber which will follow rear Platoon of its Company.

(2). TENTAGE, GREATCOATS, Etc.

(a). All tentage in possession of Coys. will be struck at 8 p.m. and dumped as follows:-

Nos.2 & 3 Coys. where Track crosses FISH AVENUE, J.5.b.2.2.
Nos.1 & 4 Coys.& Battn.H.Q. where "P" Track crosses ROBIN SUPPORT at 8 p.m.

This tentage will be left under as strong a Guard of servants & men from Transport Lines as possible and will be carried forward under Brigade arrangements to area Eastern half of Squares K.8. and K.8.b. where the Guard will re-erect it on receipt of orders. The Battalion is expected to be withdrawn to that area on the evening of Zero day.

(b). All great-coats will be dumped with tentage and taken forward under Battalion arrangements to same area. Cooking utensils will be dumped with great coats.

(c). Cookers & water-carts will proceed to above area on receipt of orders from Brigade H.Q. on evening of Zero day.

(d). Captain KEENAN will keep in touch with Brigade orders, i.e. withdrawing to above area, and superintend~~en~~ allotment & erection of tentage for the Battalion.

(3). CASUALTIES.

Total estimated casualties will be reported to Battn.H.Q. with each message sent.

Copies to:-

| | |
|---|---|
| All Coys. | (1 - 4) |
| Q.M. & T.O. | (5) |
| Capt. Keenan. | (6) |
| 1st Gds. Brigade. | (7). |
| War Diary | (8) |
| Retained. | (9 & 10). |

2/Lieut.
Asst/Adjutant. 1st Battn. Irish Guards.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1



(10). Dress. The Battn. will advance from present positions in Fighting Order - leather jerkins will be rolled in water-proof sheets. Other arms & articles carried on the man as per list issued to Company Commanders.

(11). Communication. Before Zero while in assembly positions Battn. H.Q. will be ~~[illegible]~~ K.9.c.0.9.
From Zero plus 1 hour & 30 minutes at ~~[illegible]~~ K.10.d.1.6.
From Zero plus 3 hours & 40 minutes at K.15.a.0.1.

(12). Contact Aeroplanes. Times at which contact aeroplanes fly over at
Zero plus 3 hours & 30 minutes.
Zero plus 6 hours.
Flares will be lit by leading Coys. when called for by Klaxon Horn or Very Light.
Coys. will detail 4 men per platoon to look out for contact aeroplanes.

(13). Success Signals. Rifle Grenade Success Signals (WHITE over WHITE over WHITE) will be fired by Nos. 1 & 4 Coys. on reaching BROWN LINE.

(14). Prisoners. Prisoners will be disarmed and sent to the rear under escort of lightly wounded men or 1 man to 20 prisoners. Captured Officers will be searched immediately & documents and maps sent down with escort.

(15). Synchronization of watches. A watch will be sent round for watches to be synchronized with.

(16). Aid Post.
Battn. Aid Post will be at Battn. H.Q.
A.D.S. & Walking Wounded collecting post at Zero hour will be at TROUT POST (K.7.c.2.5)

(17). S.O.S. The VI. Corps S.O.S. Signal is Rifle Grenade bursting into GREEN over RED over GREEN.

(18). Liaison. Touch will be kept with 76th Infantry Brigade on the Right & 188th Infantry Brigade on Left:-
By Nos. 3 & 4 Coys. at CROSS ROADS K.17.d with 1st Battn. GORDON HIGHLANDERS, & again at K.18.d.8.4 and By No.1 Coy. with 2nd Battn. SUFFOLK Regt. at Trench Junction K.13.d.4.2.
By No.2 Coy. with 188th Infantry Brigade on K.12.a. when it has advanced to BROWN LINE.
It is most important that whenever touch is gained with troops on Right & Left it should be at once reported to Battn. H.Q.

(19). Time Table is issued separately.

ACKNOWLEDGE.

Issued at.....P.M. Copies to:-

All Coys. (1 - 4)
Q.M. & T.O. (5)
1st Gds. Bde. (6)
2nd Bn. Gren. Gds. (7)
No. 3 Sect. No. 1 Coy. M.G. Guards. (8).
1st G.B. T.M. Batty (9).
1st Bn. Gordon Highlanders. (10).
2nd Bn. Suffolk Regt. (11).
War Diary. (12)
Retained (13 - 14)

[illegible] Capt.

1st Battn. Irish Guards.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1



move from present positions, and no smoking or lights of any kind must be shown on any account whatever.

(7). From Assembly Positions to RED LINE.

The Battn. will advance from Assembly positions at ZERO plus 35 minutes in Artillery Formation of Platoons in file, No.4 Coy Right followed by No.1 Coy., No.3 Coy.Left followed by No.2 Coy. The Right boundary being grid line dividing Squares K.9 & K.15, and Left boundary CAREY TRENCH. Boundary between Right & Left Coys. a line due E. & W. through SANDERS KEEP.
Nos.4 & 3 Coys. will pass over HINDENBURG SUPPORT Line and form up on SUNK Road due E. of STAFFORD Alley at ZERO plus 1 hour & 35 mins.
No.1 Coy. will remain in SOAP Trench ~~about grid line~~ in K.10.d.& advance from it at ZERO plus 1 hour & 50 minutes.
No.2 Coy will remain in SOAP TRENCH about grid line dividing squares K.10 & K.16 until orders from Battn. H.Q.
Battn. H.Q. will be at K.10.d.8.6. or in CAREY TRENCH, and will fly a large Green Flag with Irish Harp on it.

(8). The Attack.

(a). No.3 Coy. supported by a Creeping barrage will advance from RED LINE at ZERO plus 1 hour & 50 minutes and "mop up" SHINGLER TRENCH & SHINGLER SUPPORT as far as SUNK Road running N.& S.in K.17.b. This Coy. will then continue to "mop up" SILVER STREET as far as junction with SHERWOOD SWITCH. It will then form a defensive flank along SILVER STREET preparatory to advancing the Left flank of the Battn. to Brown Line in K.18.b. & K.12.d. when they will hold from junction of SILVER Street & SHERWOOD Switch to W. bank by light railway at K.12.d.2.7.
(b). No.4 Coy. will advance from RED LINE at ZERO plus 2 hours and reach Road in K.17.b. at ZERO plus 2 hours & 10 minutes whence it will follow the barrage and capture trench system to SHERWOOD SWITCH (inclusive) & co-operate with No.1 Coy.& capture BROWN LINE from Sugar Factory (exclusive) to junction of SILVER STREET and SHERWOOD Switch.
(c). No.1 Coy. will advance from RED LINE in support of No.4 Coy. at ZERO plus 2 hours & 30 minutes and will pass through No.4 Coy. on SHERWOOD Switch at ZERO plus 3 hours and capture SUGAR FACTORY in K.13.c. and BROWN LINE to Battn's Right boundary K.13.d.4.2.
(d). No.2 Coy. will remain in Reserve & on receipt of orders from Battn. H.Q. will move forward and occupy SHINGLER TRENCH & SHINGLER Support forming a Defensive Flank facing N. preparatory to advancing Left Flank of Battn. to BROWN LINE in K.12.a. when they will hold from light railway in K.12.d. to Sunk Road K.12.a.40.65.
(e). 1st Guards Trench Mortar Battery will detail 2 guns to advance with No.3 Coy. & come into action near SUNK Road in K.17.b. should their assistance be required. In the event of their not being required they will accompany No.4 Coy. to SHERWOOD Switch to assist in capture of Sugar Factory.
(f). No.3 Section, No.1 Coy. 4th Battn. Machine Gun Guards will be in touch with Battn. H.Q. at ZERO plus 1 hour & 35 minutes and will be prepared to:- (i) engage targets in GRAINCOURT Line, or (ii) assist in capture of Sugar Factory & consolidation of BROWN LINE in that vicinity against counter-attack.

(9). Consolidation.

All objectives as soon as captured will at once be consolidated. Green flags will be shown on reaching any objective or if hung up anywhere.

10:- Dress:-

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

APPENDIX B

SECRET. Copy No. 14

OPERATION ORDERS BY LIEUT.COL. R.R.C. BAGGALLAY. M.C.
Commanding 1st Battalion IRISH GUARDS.
"IN THE FIELD" ---:oOo:--- 26th SEPTEMBER 1918.
Ref.Map:- 57° N.E. 1/20,000.

(1). Intention. (a). The Guards Division will attack on 27th inst: in conjunction with other Divisions on either flank.
(b). Corps, Divisional, & Brigade boundaries & objectives are shown on map issued to Company Commanders.

(2). Objectives. (a). The 2nd Guards Brigade has been ordered to attack and capture RED LINE, the 1st Battn. Scots Guards capturing that part of RED LINE from junction of STAFFORD ALLEY & DARWEN ALLEY to approx: junction of OWEN TRENCH and HINDENBURG SUPPORT.
(b). The 1st Battn. IRISH GUARDS will pass through 1st Battn. Scots Guards on RED LINE at ZERO plus 1 hour & 30 minutes in order to (i) clear SHINGLER TRENCH & SHINGLER SUPPORT - SILVER STREET and Trench System between it and Brigade Southern Boundary and establish itself on BROWN LINE in L.13.a.c.& d. and on BROWN DOTTED LINE.
(ii) To advance from BROWN DOTTED LINE at approximately ZERO plus 3 hours & 45 minutes (in conformity with advance of 63rd Division through GRAINCOURT) to BROWN LINE in K.12.a. & d. and K.18.b.
(c). The 2nd Battn. Grenadier Guards will pass through the 1st Battn. IRISH GUARDS on BROWN LINE at approximately ZERO plus 4 hours & 30 minutes & capture BLUE Dotted LINE.

(3). Artillery. Three Brigades R.F.A. will cover the advance of 1st Battn. IRISH GUARDS by a creeping barrage, advancing in lifts of 100 yards every 4 minutes. On reaching BROWN LINE this barrage will cease.

(4). Machine Guns. No.3 Section of No.1 Coy. 4th Battn. MACHINE GUN GUARDS will support 1st Battn. IRISH GUARDS in attack & remain on BROWN LINE in vicinity of SUGAR FACTORY.

(5). Preliminary Moves. The 1st Battn. IRISH GUARDS will march via route already described to & reconnoitred by Companies to road between DEMICOURT and GRAYLING POST at an hour to be notified later in the following order:- No.4 Coy., No.3 Coy., No.1 Coy., No.2 Coy. with 200 yards between Platoons.
The Battn. will halt here and receive an issue of hot tea & rum.
Thence via SUNKEN ROAD leading E. from DEMICOURT To BULLEN POST to Assembly positions.
Battn. H.Q. during halt will be at junction of GRAYLING TRENCH and DEMICOURT ROAD.

(6). Assembly Positions.
(a). Preliminary. The Battn. will assemble in Artillery Formation in Square K.8.d. as follows:-
No.4 Coy. along SLAG AVENUE from grid line dividing Squares K.8 & K.14 to between ROBINSON & COOPER Trenches.
No.3 Coy. from Left of No.4 Coy. to junction with BULLEN Trench.
No.2 Coy. & No.1 Coy. along Track running N.& S. parallel to & behind SLAG AVENUE covering Nos. 3 & 4 Coys. respectively.
Guides will be met at BULLEN POST to conduct Coys. to their exact places.
(b). As soon as 1st Battn. Scots Guards advance at ZERO hour from their assembly positions in ALBAN & HUNT AVENUES, the 1st Battn. IRISH GUARDS will move into them.
The strictest silence must be observed when once troops move:-

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

## 1st BATTALION IRISH GUARDS.

## TIME TABLE of PRELIMINARY MARCH.

(1). Order of March. Nos.4., 3., 1., & 2 Coys.

(2). No.4 Coy. will march off from present position at 1 a.m.
No.1 Coy. must be clear of Road through B.27.b. & B.21.d. by 12.50 a.m. to make room for other troops but must not pass No.4 Coy.
Nos.3 & 2 Coys. join in their places as Nos.4 & 1 Coys respectively pass them.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| (3). Leading Coy.(No.4) crosses PICCADILLY. | | 1.34 a.m. |
| " " " arrives DEMICOURT-GRAYLING ROAD | | 2.34 a.m. |
| (Halt for tea & rum, etc). | | |
| Leading Coy. departs DEMICOURT CORNER. | ... | 3.34 a.m. |
| " " arrives Preliminary Assembly | ... | 4.10 a.m. |
| ALL COYS. depart Preliminary Assembly | ... | 5.10 a.m. |
| " " "arrive Assembly Trenches | ... | 5.25 a.m. |

NOTE:- O.C. No.1 Coy. will send a man on to No.3 Coy. to see if that Coy.has cut in between him & No.4 Coy. correctly.

(4). Battn. H.Q. will leave present position at 1 a.m. and go to junction of GRAYLING TRENCH and Road.

M R Barry 2/Lieut.
Asst Adjt. 1st Battn. Irish Guards.

26-9-16.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

| | PRELIMINARY ASSEMBLY LINE | | ASSEMBLY TRENCHES VACATED BY 1st Bn SCOTS GDS | | HINDENBURG SUPPORT TRENCHES | | RED LINE | | ROAD K.17.b. | | SHERWOOD SWITCH | | BROWN LINE | SUGAR FACTORY |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1st Bn Irish Guards | Arrive | Depart | Arrive | Depart | Arrive | Depart | Arrive | Depart | Arrive | Depart | Arrive | Depart | Arrive | |
| All boys (approx) | | A.M. 5.10 | 5.25 A.M. | 5.55 | 6.35 | | | | | | | | | |
| No 3 Coy. | | | | | | 6.35 | 6.50 | 7.10 | | | | | | |
| No 4 Coy | | | | | | 6.35 | 6.50 | 7.20 | | 7.30 | 8.20 | | 9.00 | |
| No 1 Coy. | | | | | | 7.25 | | 7.40 | | | 8.20 | | | 9.00 |
| No 2 Coy (Res) | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

APPENDIX C

NARRATIVE OF OPERATIONS 27-9-1918.

The Battalion left its original positions in SUPPORT according to the preliminary march time table already sent to Brigade Headquarters with copy of Operation Orders on the 26th inst:.

The Battalion halted on the DEMICOURT - GRAYLING POST Road from 2.34 a.m. to 3.34 a.m. for tea and rum. It then marched on to its assembly positions which were as follows:- Two Coys. in rear of SLAG AVENUE in K.8.d. and Two Coys. along Red Track marked in K.8.d.

The Battalion was lined up in these positions at 4.20 a.m.

At 4.45 a.m. the enemy put down a sharp barrage for ½ of an hour but most of the shells were short of the actual assembly positions.

A copy of the role assigned to the Battalion, its objectives, and the times they should be reached, has already been forwarded to Brigade Headquarters with Battalion Operation Orders. These objectives were all captured up to time with the exception of one point which will be mentioned later.

At 5.10 a.m. the Battalion was supposed to leave its assembly positions and move forward so as to reach the assembly positions of the 1st Battalion Scots Guards in AL BAN AVENUE, and HUNT AVENUE as they left tgem, but owing to its being so light and the Commanding Officer fearing the leading Coys. would be seen going across the crest line and down the forward slope, the Battalion was kept in its assembly area until Zero Hour. At Zero Hour the Battalion moved forward in Artillery Formation, Nos. 4 & 3 leading, followed by Nos. 1 & 2. Some little difficulty was experienced in crossing the assembly trenches of the 1st Battalion Scots Guards owing to the depth and width of the trenches and the enemy had rather a sharp barrage on them. This caused a temporary slight confusion but the Coys. got across and moved down to the Canal which was crossed without many casualties.

The Battalion proceeded due East making for the Red Line in the same formation as which it had started in, keeping the grid line dividing Squares K.9 and K.15 and K.10 and K.16 roughly as its Right boundary with the CAREY Trench as its Left boundary. Going across this open space the Battalion suffered a certain number of casualties, 4 Officers becoming casualties. These casualties were partly from shell fire and partly from machine gun fire from the front, and particularly from the Left front.

The Battalion then had to cross the HINDENBURG Support Trenches before reaching its barrage on the Red Line. Crossing these intricate and deep trenches was again a somewhat difficult task; a few men got lost in them and more casualtiqs were sustained on leaving them, two more Officers being hit, and several men, as they advanced to the Red Line at STAFFORD ALLEY. The leading Coys. arrived here quite punctually and picked up their barrage. One Coy. proceeded up SHINGLER and SHINGLER Support where they found very little to mop up, the other Coy. proceeding on its Right making for its objective which was SHERWOOD Switch. The barrage seemed rather slow.

Touch was gained by the Right leading Coy. with the 1st Battalion Gordon Highlanders who were capturing ELESQUERIES on their Right in magnificent style. This Right Coy. sustained casualties from machine guns in the Northern outskirts of ELESQUERIES, but reached their objective up to time keeping in touch all the while with the Company clearing up SILVER Street. The Right leading Coy. was followed all the way by the right hand Company of the two rear Coys (No.1 Coy.) This Coy. passed through the leading Coy. at SHERWOOD Switch according to plan and got up to the X-ROADS in K.13.d. at 9 o'clock, where they arrived rather weak, having sustained casualties on the way. Arrived at these ~~#~~ X-ROADS they were subjected to somewhat severe machine gun fire from the North-East at no very

reat:-

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1



great range, and from the BEETROOT Factory. Captain OGILVY and a few men tried to work up to the SUGAR Factory which was the objective of that Company, but becamse casualties. As that Company continued to have casualties they were unable to get further on and they took up their position on the edge of the SUNK Road round the L-Roads in K.13.d. The Reserve Company (No.2 Coy.) moved up in rear and formed a defensive flank in SILVER Street, joining on there with the Company already in it.

Shortly after 9 o'clock the Battalion was where it had been arranged it should be with the exception that No.1 Coy. instead of being in and around the SUGAR Factory was short of it as already described. GRAINCOURT and the GRAINCOURT Line not having been taken at 9 o'clock as it was supposed to have been, it was impossible to move forward the Left flank of the Battalion according to plan, and for the same reason other troops who were supposed to pass through the Battalion were unable to do so.

The Battalion now began to suffer further casualties from a hostile battery firing from the North-East with open sights from the neighbourhood of ORIVAL Wood. Touch was gained with the 1st Battn. Gordon Highlanders on the Battalion boundary in SHERWOOD Switch, but little was seen of the 2nd Battn. Suffolk Regiment who were supposed to pass the Brown Line on our Right at 9 o'clock.

Everything on the Battalion front now seemed at a stand-still, no troops being able to go on owing to the situation on the Left flank being unsatisfactory. A Tank came up on the Right flank of the Battalion and cleared the machine guns out of the SUGAR Factory, and a Company of the 1st Battalion Grenadier Guards moved up towards PRESSY CHAPEL.

The Battalion H.Q. was at K.18.b.6.4.

Lieut. Colonel.

Commanding 1st Battalion Irish Guards.

29-9-1918.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

Instructions regarding War Diaries and Intelligence Summaries are contained in F. S. Regs., Part II. and the Staff Manual respectively. Title pages will be prepared in manuscript.

# WAR DIARY
or
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form C. 2118.

(1)

SEPTEMBER. 1918. 1st Bn Irish Guards.

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ADINFER WOOD | 1/9/18. | | The Bn remained for the day in shelters + tents along E. edge of ADINFER WOOD. At night Enemy aeroplanes flew over + dropped a lot of bombs in the neighbourhood and at 10 pm dropped H among the tents and shelters in the trench where No 2 Coy were. Six casualties were caused - 1 man in No 1 Coy being wounded by a splinter and 5 men buried in the trench. They were dug out as quickly as possible but 2 died from suffocation. | ERVILLERS Map Ed. 1a. |
| HAMEL SWITCH near HAMLINCOURT. | 2/9/18. | | At 3.30 pm the Bn (all Coys) marched via AYETTE, MOYENNEVILLE, HAMLINCOURT to HAMEL SWITCH trench in S. 30 a + c, Batt Hd Qrs in A. 6. b. The men made themselves shelters in the trench with corrugated iron + wood material lying about. The Bn remained there for the night. | |
| LAGNICOURT. | 3/9/18. | | The 1st Gds Bde were in Divisional Reserve and marched to LAGNICOURT. The Bn crossed the SENSEE Valley in B. 8. a + b + went across the battlefield of Aug 27th via HAILLY COPSE to ECOUST St MEIN where dinners were eaten. At 4 pm the Bn proceeded to LAGNICOURT trench just W. of LAGNICOURT. The trench was only waist deep + had no cover but the men soon made some from material lying about. Cookers + L.G. limbers accompanied the Bn. There was no shelling altho' much traffic on the road + a good deal of it in full view of BOULON WOOD. | |

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(2)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| LAGNICOURT | 4/9/18 to 6/9/18. | | The Bn remained just W. of LAGNICOURT. occupying the French front line from road in C.29.b to C.17.d.7.1. Bn H.Q. were in a dugout on road at C.17.d.2.0. There was a little spasmodic shelling of LAGNICOURT village and our trench by a high velocity gun. The 1st line transport which had been for 2 days at MORCUIL moved to Sunk road C.15.d. Seventeen aeroplane bombs were dropped on the Bn lines one night but only 2 men were slightly wounded. | Map. Sheet 57c N.W. |
| Front line near MOEUVRES. | 7/9/18. | | The Bn relieved the 1st Bn Scots Guards in the front line. Dispositions as follows:— No 3 Coy [right front] from E.25.b.7.0 to E.20.c.2.3. Thence to road at E.19.a.2.9. under the command of Capt. G.L.St.C. Rainsford. H.Q. No 4 Coy [right support] from E.13.a.0.4 to E.13.c.4.3 and from E.19.a.2.9. to O.18.d.6.3. thence to E.13.b.0.0. under the temporary command of 2nd Lt. C.S. Hutchinson. No 1 Coy [left front] from E.13. central to E.20.a.2.9. thence to E.19.b.7.5. under the command of Capt. G.K. Thompson M.C. No 2 Coy [left support] from E.13. central to E.13.c.5.3. thence to E.19.a.8.9. under the command of Capt. A.W.L. Paget. Battalion H.Q. were at D.18.d.5.4. on the Western edge of TADPOLE COPSE. | M.L. MOEUVRES L 20. 008 |
| | 8th | | The Bn had a quiet relief which was complete at 1.10 A.M. on the 8th After relief had been reported complete the enemy shelled very heavily with gas [BLUE X] & H.E. especially round Bn. H.Q. | |

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| Front Line near MOEUVRES | 8/9/18 | 6.30 P.M. | The morning was spent improving our own trenches & endeavouring to locate enemy's exact positions.<br>At 6.30 P.M. Nos 1 & 3 Coys attempted to push forward their outposts with a view to<br>(1) Improving their position<br>(2) Locating & finding out strengths of enemy posts.<br>(3) Closing the gap between the two front Coys.<br>No 3 Coy pushed forward patrols up the trench from E.20.c.3.3. and met with opposition about E.20.c.50.25; they drove the enemy up the trench as far as E.20.c.8.1. but were unable to proceed any further owing to the strength of enemy's resistance. They then proceeded to build a barricade there, but were very heavily counter raided, both down the trench and over the top by about 20 men under 2 officers & were forced to retire to their original positions. Here the enemy were beaten off, after having made a good attempt to get into our trenches, with a few casualties to himself. | Map. MOEUVRES 1/20,000 |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Front Line near MOEUVRES | 8/9/18 | | A second party of No 3 Coy under 2/Lt H.G. DARBY made a strong attempt to reach the trench junction at E,20,a,4,0, But owing to the strong opposition encountered it was not thought advisable to make any further effort until the Trench Mortars had reduced the resistance of the garrison. | Map MOEUVRES 1/20,000 |
| | | 7. P.M. | No 1 Coy worked down the trench from E,20,a,2,8, and reached the point E,20,a,5,4,. It was not thought advisable however to proceed any further until enemy posts had been taken at E,20,a,6,3,. But the ground gained was consolidated. | |
| | | | During the night an enemy party of about 12 O.R. were seen coming towards our line at E,20,a,5,8,. They were at once engaged with rifle, Lewis Gun fire, and bombs. Several men appear to have been hit, as screams & groans were heard. And several men were seen to fall. We secured one wounded prisoner. | |
| | | | One platoon of No 2 Coy was brought up in support to assist No 1 Coy, if necessary, and were disposed from E,20,a,2,9,. to E,19,b,8,5,. | |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Front Line NEAR MOEUVRES | 9/1/K | 2.20 p.m. | Attempts were made by the enemy to raid our lines in several places. At 2.20 p.m. a large raiding party of about 15 O.R. entered our line at E, 20, a, 5, 7. and secured 5 prisoners. Of the 5 men captured 2 were stretcher bearers (unarmed) and the other 3 had not been in the line before. They were unaware of the way down the trench from our post the quarter of which the enemy suddenly appeared and covered them with revolvers. They were at least 200 yds from the nearest post. Owing to the shape of the ground, and our close proximity to the fronted houses round MOEUVRES such a raid was comparatively easy. | Map MOEUVRES 1 / 20,000 |
| | | | Trench mortars carried out a shoot on enemy posts in E.20.a.9.6. preparatory for an intended raid by us the next morning. This did not take place owing to Box barrage not arriving. | |
| | | 4.30 p.m. | No 1 Coy sent strong patrols to secure the trench as far as E,14,c,3,9. This was successful and touch was obtained with No 2 on our left (2nd Lincolnshire Regt.) No 1 Coy then proceeded to push forward along Sap E to E,14,c,1.6., as far as E,14,c,1.6., opposite to which a counter was found at E,14,c,2.4. | |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Front line MOEUVRES | 9/10 | | Night of 9th 10th Bn was relieved by 1/5th Bn Royal North Lancs. They had not sufficiently reconnoitred their route before relief & failed to meet our guides at the point we had mutually chosen. They were very heavily shelled and their Coys lost their way. The relief was consequently very slow. The night was moonless & rain fell incessantly. Last Coys (No 3) relief was not complete until 4.30 A.M. on the 10th | Map MOEUVRES 1/20,000 |
| Trenches N and E of D, 21, c & d | 10/10 | | On completion of relief Bn was disposed in trenches in D, 21, c & d with Bn H.Q. at D, 21, d, 1, 5,. | " |
| | 11/10 | | 1st Guards Brigade relieved 3rd Guards Brigade in reserve. 1st Bn Irish Guards relieved 1st Bn Grenadier Guards. On completion of relief Coys were disposed as follows: Nos 1, 2, & 4 Coys in trenches D, 20, d central to D, 20, a, 1, 6,. No 3 Coy in EDINBURGH SUPPORT D, 19, b,. Battalion H.Q. at D, 25, d, 8, 7,. Quiet relief. | " |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| ~~Sept 12~~ Trenches E of LAGNICOURT | 12 9 18 to 14 9 18 | | The Bn remained in same positions. There was no shelling on the Bn at all. A large dump of salvage was made at Bn H.Q and Coys collecting in their areas and carrying to Bn H.Q. Major General complimented Bn on its dumps. | Map 57c N.E 1 / 20,000 |
| Trenches W of LAGNICOURT | 15 9 18 | | The Bn moved back to its former positions of Sept 4th just W of LAGNICOURT. Bn H.Q. & Coys occupying " exactly the same positions as before. The Bn relieved 1st Bn Scots Guards. The first Coy marched off at 5 p.m. Coys marched independently across country with 200 yards interval between platoons. | |
| " | 16 9 18 | | Bn remained in same positions. A little training was done in the morning; 40 minutes drill, 30 minutes bayonet and physical drill, 30 minutes musketry & 10 minutes Box Respirator Drill. Beer was obtained for the men & sent up from transport lines. | |

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 17 9/18 | | The Bn relieved the 2nd Bn Scots Guards in support line that evening. First Coy moved off at 6.30 am. Coys moved at 20 minutes interval with 200 yds between platoons. No 2 Coy relieved a Coy of 1st Bn Welsh Guards. On completion of relief companies were disposed as follows. — No 2 Coy in area Old British Front line from junction of FISH AVENUE to SPRAT POST — in FISH AVENUE & in SHARK SUPPORT. Then a gap filled by Res Coy 2nd Bn Coldstream Guards (Front line Bn). No 3 Coy in area junction of RABBIT ALLEY with old British Front line to RAT ALLEY, & in ROBIN SUPPORT. No 4 Coy from left of No 3 Coy in old British front line, to junction with ROBIN ALLEY and in ROBIN SUPPORT. No 1 Coy in area D, 27, a in CENTRAL AVENUE. Battalion H.Q D, 21, d, 0.5. Defence scheme showing action in case of attack is attached and marked appendix A. No 2 Coy had 2 casualties during relief which was reported complete at 11.30 p.m. | Map 57c N.E. 1/20,000 |

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
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| | 18 9/18 | | Bn remained in same positions. The morning was quiet except for desultory shelling on No 2 Coy. In the afternoon the enemy apparently attacked S of the Divisional front, 9 just S of BAPAUME—CAMBRAI road. The Bn was subjected to somewhat heavy shelling the whole afternoon, but only 6 casualties were sustained. Capt VERNON (Vernon) at Bn H.Q. was slightly wounded & remained at duty. | Map 57c N.E. 1 20,000 |
| | 19 9/18 to 25 9/18 | | The Bn remained in same dispositions. There was a little shelling from time to time causing a few casualties but on the whole the week covered by these dates was quiet. | |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| SUPPORT TRENCHES to ASSEMBLY POSITION. | 26/9/18. | | A cold drizzling day. The ~~Bde~~ Nos 4 & 3 Coys had to move out of their trenches & dug outs by 10 am to make room for other troops & were rather ill-protected against the weather. The day was spent in preparing for the attack we were to deliver next day. a copy of OPERATION ORDERS is attached & marked appendix A | |
| The attack on FLESQUIERES. | 27/9/18. | | The Bn marched off to DEMICOURT – GRAYLING POST road according to time table of Preliminary march and halted there for tea & rum. It was a pouring wet morning and the men got very wet going there. There was no shelling while the Bn was moving down to this rendezvous nor during the halt there. At 3.30 am the Companies moved off in the following order No 4, No 3, No 1 No 2 Coys along the DEMICOURT – GRAINCOURT road to BULLEN POST, K.8.G.3.1 where guides previously sent on met them & led them to their exact forming up positions. Narrative of operations from this period onwards is attached & marked Appendix C. About 3. pm the Division on our left attacked GRAINCOURT again & captured it after which the situation was relieved and the Bn was no longer subjected to artillery fire. The 2nd Div. were also able to pass through and go on towards their objective NOYELLES | |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| FLESQUIERES | 27/9/18 | | The Bn remained in its positions the remainder of the day and for the night. The companies reorganised & made themselves as comfortable as they could but the trenches were very bad being only knee or waist deep. The night was very cold.. No rations or water were sent up as the Bde was to be relieved next morning. This was not a Bn order but came from higher authority. Casualties were 180 O.R. and Seven officers. one of 15 offrs. In addition the M.O. was killed. | |
| Area S K.7.d | 28/9/18 | | At 6.30 am. the Bn received orders that it could withdraw to area K.7.d. and at 7 am the leading company moved off. Owing to no rations having been sent up or water the men could have no hot tea or breakfast before going as officers either; & had a 6,000 yds march back on empty stomachs. Just as the last company arrived it commenced to rain & was very cold. The Bn was accomodated in Trench shelters and bivouacs. | |
| do do. | 29/9/18 | | The Bn remained in same disposition & the day was spent in washing and Shaving. making lists of deficiencies etc. The morning was fine but the afternoon & evening wet & cold. | |
| do do. | 30/9/18 | | Bn remained in same disposition. Men went to baths at DOINGTS | |

Roman Cappellaz Lt Col
Comdg 1st Bn Inf Bde.

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Lieut. H. A. A. Collett. Compd. Course of Instrn. at VI Corps Infy. School 14-9-18. | |
| | | | 2)Lt. A,H.O'Farrell. -- do -- | |
| | | | Capt Hon. D. A. A. Ogilvy. Compd. Course of Instrn. at 3rd Army Infantry School 2-9-18. | |
| | | | 2/Lt. H. G. Darby. Course of Instrn. at VI Corps Infantry School 25-9-18. | |
| | | | Capt. C.K. Thompson. M.C. Admitted to Hospital 27-9-18. | |
| | | | Capt. D.J. Hegarty. Granted leave to U.K. 3-9-18 to 17-9-18. | |
| | | | Major Hon. W.S.P. Alexander. Leave to U.K. 19-9-18 to 3-10-18. | |
| | | | Capt. A.W.L. Paget. - do - 28-9-18 to 13-10-18. | |
| | | | Lieut. D.S. Browne. - do - 29-9-18 to 13-9-18. | |
| | | | Lieut. B.S. Close. Joined Battn, for duty 1-9-18. | |
| | | | " R.L. Dagger. -- do -- 1-9-18. | |
| | | | 2/Lt. E.H.H. Burke. -- do -- 1-9-18. | |
| | | | " J.J.B. Brady. -- do -- 1-9-18. | |
| | | | Lieut. C.W.N. Bence-Jones. -- do -- 6-9-18. | |
| | | | " L.D. Murphy. -- do -- 6-9-18. | |
| | | | 2/Lt. G.F. Todd. -- do -- 23-9-18. | |
| | | | Lieut. H.S.L. Smith. M.C. -- do -- 24-9-18. | |
| | | | Capt. C.A.J. Vernon. -- do -- 13-9-18 | |
| | | | 321 Other ranks joined for duty during month. | |
| | | | Lieut. C.A.J. Vernon. Wounded(Gas)27-9-18.) Not shown last month | |
| | | | 2/Lt. G.T. Heaton. -- do -- ) | |
| | | | Lieut. B.S. Close. Killed in Action 27-9-18. | |
| | | | 2/Lt. A.H.O'Farrell. -- do -- 27-9-18. | |
| | | | Capt. Hon. D.A.A. Ogilvy. Wounded in Action 27-9-18. | |
| | | | 2/Lt. A.R. Boyle. -- do -- 27-9-18. | |
| | | | " C.F. Mathieson. -- do -- 27-9-18. | |
| | | | " C.S. O'Brien. M.C. -- do -- 27-9-18. | |
| | | | Lieut. C.W.N. Bence-Jones. -- do -- 27-9-18. | |
| | | | 21 Other Ranks Killed in Action during month. | |
| | | | 159 " " Wounded - do - - do - | |
| | | | 51 " " Missing. | |
| | | | 14 " " evacuated (ill) | |
| | | | 4 " " Struck off Strength. | |
| | | | 249 | |

| | Officers. | O.R. |
|---|---|---|
| Approximate Fighting Strength 1-9-18:- | 25 | 784 |
| Joined during month:- | 9 | 321 |
| | 34 | 1105 |
| Left during month:- | 9 | 249 |
| Approximate Fighting Strength 30-9-18:- | 25 | 856 |

Roman Baggallay
Lt Col.
Cmdg 1st Bn Irish Guards.

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1st Gds. Bde. Gds. Div.

# War Diary.

# 1st Bn. Irish Guards.

## October 1918.

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1 Irish Bde 16 Div

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| DEMICOURT K.7. | 1/10/18 | | Bn in Old British Trenches with tents and Bivouacs for Shelter. During the Bn stay in this area Companies have been organised after the fighting of 27 Sept 1918. Companies have at the disposal of Coy Commanders daily for Company Training in open warfare. A certain amount of open drill and Physical drill have also done to make the men fit | APPENDIX MAP "A" |
| " | 2/10/18 | | All Companies marched for 6 hours on roads between RAVINCOURT and FLESQUIERES. | |
| " | 3/10/18 | | Orders were received to move, but were cancelled. LIEUT VAN du NOOT H.E and LIEUT VAN du NOOT B.E.F. Joined Bn for duty | |
| " | 4/10/18 | | Commanding Officer proceeded on leave. MAJOR A.F.L GORDON M.C. assumed command | |
| " | 5/10/18 | | Orders again received to move, but again cancelled. 2nd Lt KOCH de GOOREYND A.W.L. " Hon BARNWELL. C.A. " TYLDEN-WRIGHT. G.M " FRENCH V.J.S " H.E. TAYLOR. } Joined Bn for duty | |

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| DEMICOURT K.7 | 6/10/18 | | Bde was warned that it would probably move tomorrow. | |
| | 7/10/18. | 10.30 | G.O. attended conference at Bde H.Qrs. At the conference plans were given for the operations that were to take place on the 8th. The 2nd Div (Left) and the 3rd Div (right) were to attack on the whole corps front at dawn on the 8th. The Guards Div was to be prepared to go through the 2nd and 3rd Divs on the afternoon of the 8th and to take over the line on the night of the 8/9th and resume the attack next morning at dawn. The 1st Gds Bde to pass through the 3rd Div. and 2nd Gds Bde through the 2nd Div. 3rd Gds Bde in Reserve. 1st to went of the 1st Gds Bde going through the 2nd Bde Coldstream Gds (Right) and 2nd Bde Grenadier Gds (Left) were to be in front and 1st Bde Irish Gds in Reserve | |
| | | 18.00. | Bde left DEMICOURT and proceeded via Track 7 – FLESQUIERES – RIBECOURT to the HINDENBURG LINE about L.20 a. Bde remained in this area accommodated in dugouts and shelters for the night. The Bde arrived about area 21.30 | |
| HINDENBURG LINE L.20 a | 8/10/18 | 09.30 | Bde at 1 hours notice from 07.30 Orders received for Bde to proceed via MARCOING to MASNIERS. Bde moved off at 10.00 and reached MASNIERS where Bde halted in the area G.21.C. Bde arrived about 13.00. No 3 by bad weather, whilst crossing the CANAL DE St QUENTIN which was being shelled by long range guns while the Bde was passing. | APPENDIX MAP "A" |
| | | | The Bde remained in bivouacs in MASNIERS for the remainder of the day. At 18.00 Commanding Officers went to Bde where orders were issued for the attack of the 1st Gds Bde on the 9th (Tomorrow) | APPENDIX MAP "B" |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | 19.30 | A conference of Company Commanders was held at Bde HQrs at which verbal orders were issued as to the part to be taken by the Bn. | |
| MASNIERS G.21.C. | 9/10/18 | 02.40 | Bn started via Cross-roads at S edge of RUMILLY – CREVECOEUR – SUR L'ESCAUT, to the assembly area along road running from G.29 & 30 to EPINE X roads in G.23 b. The Bn was formed up from the Right in order 4 3 2 1 Coys At the time the Bde Conference it was not known for certain if the 3rd Div had reached the green line or not. Orders were issued by the Corps that all troops would be established on the green line before Zero on the 9th and at Zero (05.20) a creeping barrage would be put down on the green line under which the 2nd Coy and 2 Sec. would advance to the attack. | APPENDIX MAP 3 |
| ASSEMBLY AREA | 0500 | | Bn arrived in artillery formation from the assembly area to the red line about 05.15. Bn halted on red line according to orders and leadforts were eaten. There was no enemy shelling at all from the time the Bn formed up in the assembly area, and even when the creeping barrage was put down, there was practically no enemy shelling at all. The attack of the 2nd Div did not get off to a good start. Heavy M.G. fire from the direction of ST LEGER caused the attack of the 2nd Div to be held up. The Bn H.Qrs were in the red line about H.19 b.1.4. | |
| RED LINE | 08.30 | | Orders were received from Bde to move to GREEN LINE | |
| GREEN LINE | 09.15. | | Bn arrived at GREEN LINE. Bn H.Qrs being found at the X roads in LA TARGETTE Nos 3 and 4 bys were in the open on the S.E. outskirts of LA TARGETTE and Nos 1 and 2 bys on the N.W. outskirts Bde H.Qrs moved to the X roads in LA TARGETTE about the same time. | |

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| GREEN LINE | 9/10/18. | 11.15 | B[a] moved to RAILWAY EMBANKMENT in H 11 C and d. via open country S.E. of HAMBAIX arriving at RAILWAY about 12.30. | APPENDIX 28 MAP "B" |
| RAILWAY EMBANKMENT H. 11 C and d. | | 12.30 | B[a] remained on Rly EMBANKMENT. The men making small shelters for themselves to sleep on on the embankment. B[e] H.Q[s] were in a TUNNEL under the embankment. | |
| | | 23.15 | Orders were received on the telephone from the Bde that the B[e] would pass through the 2nd B[e] COLDSTREAM GDS and 2nd B[e] GRENADIER GDS at Zero (05.00). The detailed orders were received, except that the B[e] would continue the advance. On receipt of this information company commanders were assembled and each company sent out an officer and some N.C.Os to reconnoitre assembly area for their companies. | |
| 10/10/18 | 01.35. | | Detailed orders with maps were received from Bde, and company commanders were again assembled and given verbal orders for the advance and assembly. The B[e] was to attack on a 3 company front and 1 in Reserve. No 4 on RIGHT No 3 CENTRE No 2 LEFT No 1 RESERVE. The attack was to be carried out by 3 bounds and without any artillery barrage. Patrols were to be sent out at Zero to the 1st Bound and as soon as they reported 1st bound clear of the enemy remainder of companies were to push on to the 1st Bound, while patrols pushed on to the 2nd Bound. This method of advance was to be continued throughout. There was no limit to the advance of the B[e]. Touch was to be gained with B[de] on Right and left at each bound. The NEW ZEALAND DIV were on the Right and 1st B[e] SCOTS GDS on left. Companies were organised into 3 platoons. 1 Platoon of each of the front 3 Co[s] were to consist of 2 fighting patrols consisting of 1 Rifle section | |

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| | | | and 1 Lewis Gun Section each. | APPENDIX MAP "B" |
| | | 05.00 | Bn started off from the RAILWAY EMBANKMENT at their own times and formed up in the area already reconnoitred, just in rear of the 2nd C.G and 2nd G.G who were lightly on the BLUE DOTTED LINE. | |
| | | | Owing to the morning being very dark, the Patrols were not sent out till about 05.10 | |
| | | | Bn H.Qs established at H 12 b 2.8, in CATENNIERES. | |
| | | | The assembly of the Bn has carried out under very great conditions. There being no | |
| | | | shelling at all. | |
| | | | The 2nd Bn COLDSTREAM GDS were in SUPPORT and 2nd Bn GRENADIER GDS in RESERVE. | |
| | | | Bn had attached for the operations 1 Section Corps Cyclists (7 OR) and 1 Battery R.F.A | |
| | | 06.50 | Patrols have reported to have reached the 1st Bound. The only opposition met with | |
| | | | has encountered on the RIGHT of No 4 boy from Snipers from houses in BEAUVOIS-EN | |
| | | | -CAMBRESIS 2nd Lt V.J.S. FRENCH was killed by one of the Snipers | |
| | | | Bn H.Q's moved to FRESNOY FME. | |
| | | | As the Patrols advanced to the 2nd bound they were subjected to a good deal of | |
| | | | Artillery fire and BEVILLERS was heavily shelled | |
| | | | On account of the heavy shelling of BEVILLERS No 3 Company was ordered to clear the | |
| | | | village and proceed via outer flank, and only to send 2 Platoons passing right through into | |
| | | | the village itself. | |
| | | | No 4 Company again came up against enemy opposition both MG's and Snipers. This | |
| | | | opposition was quickly overcome. | |

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| | | 08.00 | 2nd Bound was reported clear by the patrols and B.H.Q. moved to C 22 C 86. Enemy shelling was heavy during the advance of the B. from the 2nd to 3rd Bound | APPENDIX MAP. 13 |
| | | 09.00. | Patrols reaching the line C. 29. b. 7. 0. – C 23 a 8. 0. – C 17 C 45. on the high ground were held up by M.G. fire along the whole B. front. B. on the Right and Left were also held up. The enemy resistance appeared to be a continuous line of posts with M.G.s. There did not appear to be any chance of gaining the 3rd Bound without artillery support of some kind. Consequently therefore consolidated the ground gained and patrols have frequently sent out to in order to gain early information of any weakening in the part of the enemy. | |
| | | | B. H.Q. moved to sunken road at C. 23. b. 1, 8, at 09.30. | |
| | | | B. remained in the position and was subjected to almost continuous indiscriminate artillery fire the whole day. The rain day also for themselves and for artillery observation was very much hampered. | |
| | | 16.00 | There are signs of the enemy's resistance weakening, and Patrols are pushed forward that another 600 yds. on the whole B. front. | |
| | | 17.00 | The B. had reached the 3rd Bound on the whole B. front. | |
| | | 17.50. | Information was received from the N.Z. division on our right, that the Div on their right had pushed forward and were endeavouring to secure high ground in K.B. Central. Also that the B. on our right was moving to push forward to hold a line through D 23 Central to FONTAINE AU TERTRE Farm. Just after this message was received a message was received from No 14 Group to say | APPENDIX MAP "D" |

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| | | | That three patrols were advancing on the 4th Bound and that they were to find out the N.E. DW at that night. On receipt of this information No 3 and 2 Coys were ordered to send Patrols to the 4th Bound. | APPENDIX MAP D. |
| | | 22.30 | Owing to the darkness progress to the 4th Bound was slow and all Companies were not reported to be established on their front line about 22.30 | |
| | | | Bn HQs moved to a house in the N outskirts of QUIEVY about 20.30. | |
| | | | No 1 Coy remained in Reserve in QUIEVY. | |
| | | | The night passed quietly except for some shelling of QUIEVY and HAUTERTRE Rue. | |
| | | | Touch was not gained with the 1/5th SCOTS GDS on the left | |
| | | | Patrols moved about 21.30 and were ordered to keep contact any trouble. | |
| | 11/12/18 | 05.00 | Others were moved about 22.30 but 3rd GDS BDE should have Troops in at 06.00 the latest moving. | |
| | | 06.30 | 1st/5th GRENADIER GDS passed through the 1st. After advancing about 700 to 800 yds they were held up by M.G. fire. They were not able to get any further that day eventually digging in about 600 to 800 yds S.W of the Railway in D.12 | |
| | | 13.00 | Orders were received for the Bn to withdraw and to billet in N.E half of QUIEVY and the 1/5th COLDSTREAM GDS on the S.W half. On receipt of these orders Nos 2 3 and 4 Coys were immediately withdrawn into Coy and Bn Billets in QUIEVY. The men having both cellar and upstairs rooms. All billets were very dirty owing to the previous occupants (about) apparently having taken a delight in scattering all the bedding clothes, food, furniture etc all over the place. | |

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Bn H.Q's and No 1 Coy proceeded to the Billets they already occupied in Bouzincourt.

Here greatcoats and kits were brought up from the transport which had not joined BEHILLERS.

The men had very little sleep last night but were in the best of spirits.

Rain started about 12.30 p.m. but did not interfere with us. Up to this time the weather had been extraordinary fine for the time of year.

The following Officers were left in Bn during these operations the remainder being on leave or at the details.

No 1 Coy.
Lt H.E. VAN DE NOOT
2nd Lt J.C. HAYDON
2nd Lt R.E. TAYLOR.

No 2 Coy.
Lt E.M. HARVEY. M.C
2nd Lt J.T. TODD.
" Robt L. KOCH de GOOREYND.

No 3 Coy
Lt F.S.L SMITH M.C.
2nd Lt G.E.F. VAN DE NOOT.
2nd Lt J.J.B BRADY.

No 4 Coy
CAPT. D.J. HEGARTY
2nd Lt Hon C.A. BARNWELL
2nd Lt V.J.S. FRENCH (Killed)

Bn H.Q.
MAJOR A.F. GORDON. M.C.
CAPT J.B. KEENAN
G.L St.C. BAMBRIDGE A.C

Total casualties for 10th and 11th were 1 officer and 3 O.R Killed and 9 O.R wounded.

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| ROUVROY | 12/10/18 | | 13th Remained in ROUVROY. Companies at disposal of Company Commanders for Games. Cleaning up. ROUVROY has shelled slightly at various times. 13th Div on 1 hours notice to hold the main line of defence. | |
| " | 13/10/18 | | 13th Div on 1 hours notice. Cleaning of Billets and Billeted. 2nd B. C. G. relieved 1st GG in front line. 2nd B. GG took over Billets in ROUVROY from 2nd C G. | |
| " | 14/10/18 | | Company Commanders lectured their companies on the recent fighting. Physical Drill and Bde Inspection drill was also done. Owing to the possibility of shelling the parades were to be larger than a platoon. 13th on 2 hours notice. | |
| " | 15/10/18 | | Companies again at disposal of Company Commanders for Platoon Parades. Enemy shelled the centre of village during the afternoon, but caused no casualties to the occupants in the 13th. While 13th was Billeted and moved about clothes. | |
| " | 16/10/18 | | The companies were to have the Company Training to commence but had to be cancelled. 13th Remained in ROUVROY. | |
| " | 17/10/18 | 12.00 | Brigade Conference held at H.Q. 2nd 13th BRIGADIER GDS HQ about the inspections which are to take place about the 20th Oct. | |
| " | 18/10/18 | 13.00 | 13th left ROUVROY for LA BOUSSIÈRE via LONG CAUSEY Starting point 16 HQ 13th HQ at C 20 d 3.8. The companies were in Billets close to 13th H.Q. Inspection of Company Commanders was held at 13th HQ at 18.30 at which the plan of the coming operations was given. | |

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| BOUSBIERE | | | CAPT A.W.L. PAGET who had returned from leave has transferred temporarily to Command No 1 Company and 2nd Lt O.R. BALDWIN to Command No 4 Company. The changes have been notified by Second Officer being to Base | |
| | 15/10/15. | 09.15. | Message received from the O.C. 1st Essex under 6 ST HILAIRE brought. Conference held at Report of Company Commanders for Tuesday and the employment of the operations which will take place | |
| ST HILAIRE. | | 17.15. | 13th Bde to ST HILAIRE during night 18/19th. All Companies will be marched in Billets here by 7 P.M. Dinners. 13th A.G. Bde Church | |
| | | 18.30 | Conference of Commanding Officers held at 124 Bde. Orders for the attack issued shortly changed. The attack has to be carried out by 2 Bdes and not by 1 as previously arranged. Most of the important details have been altered. Maps & Sketches were also issued. The following morning: | |
| | 19/10/18 | | All Company Commanders and CAPT VERNON (Bde Intelligence Officer) left billets at 7 A.M. to go to high ground in N.28 a to look at the ground over which the attack has to take place. | APPENDIX MAP "C" |
| | | 14.15. | Conference of Company Commanders at Bde H.Qrs at which final details relating to the attack were issued. For Boundaries etc see Map attached. | |
| | | 17.30. | An advance party consisting of 1 officer and 2 N.C.Os per Coy under CAPT VERNON left to proceed to the assembly area to mark out Company [illegible] and also to [illegible] | |

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| LINE | | 21·30 | B[e] Head Qrs in area H.28 Z 1 3 4 boys to the assembly area preceding the D.D. 1 3 — D 2 a 4 2 — Head were taken by the Railway at V.27 d 89, by the guides for Advanced Party last boys. The above route was taken to avoid going through ST KAAST which was frequently shelled. | APPENDIX MAPS "C" and "D" |
| | | 23·45 | B[e] arrived at the assembly area. Nos 1 and 2 boys left disposed in line along the line of the Rly inside the B[e] boundary No 3 boy in Support 200 yds in rear in Reserve 300 yds in rear of No 3 boy facing. B[e] H.Qrs on Railway on right of No 1 boy. Shelter trenches were dug by all boys in case of shell fire. The night was light, But rain started just before the B[e] left ST HILAIRE and continued on and off till about 06·00 the following morning. The condition for the attack were therefore as about as bad as could be. The ground was very heady and the light was not nearly as good as it would have been if it had been fine. | APPENDIX MAP "C" |
| | 20/10/18 | | On arrival at the assembly area all boy parties sent reconnoitring parties down to the river SELLE to locate the footbridges which had been put up by the R.E. 4 Bridges were available in the B[e] front. The 2nd B[e] GRENADIER GDS formed up on the Right of the B[e]. The 2nd B[e] COLDSTREAM GDS who were in Support formed up at Zero. Except for occasional bursts of machine gun fire, the night was very quiet and no enemy shelling of the assembly area. | |

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| LINE | | 01.46 | The 2 first bys left their assembly area and proceeded to form up along the road ready to cross the bridges at Zero. Nos 5 and 6 Bdes were allotted to No 1 by and 7 and 8 to No 2 by. No 3 by followed by the 2 first companies No 4 by halted up to the line of the Railway at 01.55 where it remained till Zero + 23 minutes. | APPENDIX MAP 'C' |
| | | 02.00 | At the creeping Barrage opened and the 2 first bys moved to their jumping off line followed by No 3 by and formed up under the Barrage along the line of the Sanchez road in V.24.d<br>Bde H.Qrs remained in the Rly Cut 02.30 when it moved to the Sanchez road about V 30 b 38.<br>Bde H Qrs visited throughout the operations, both the Heads of the 2nd & 3rd GRENADIER GDS in case that they might be in close touch with each other.<br>There was very little artillery fire, But a certain amount of Machine Gun and Rifle fire. | |
| | | 03.10 | 3rd Bde had reached the first objective, was also had the 2nd S.G. on our right. Touch has not gained with the 3rd GDS Bde on the | |

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| LINE | | | Left. The enemy resistance up to this front had not been very strong, but several pockets and Machine Guns were captured. Our casualties had been very light. About F.O.R. nearly all hit by shrapnel. | APPENDIX MAP C |
| | | | The companies had maintained their direction very well under very difficult conditions. Many slight mistakes were rectified during the last on the 1st objective. | |
| | 04.06 | | The advance to the final objective has started. After having the 1st objective the enemies resistance stiffened and his machine Gun fire increased. There has been very little enemy artillery retaliation. | |
| | 04.35 | | The final objective was reached according to timetable. The 2nd Bn G.J. were up in line on the Right. No touch was got with the 3rd Bn (DS) on the left, which made the advance and the subsequent consolidation of No 2 Company exceedingly difficult. The 3rd Lds BDE did not come up on our Left till about 05.00 having been held up in front of the 1st objective. | |
| | | | Bn H.Qrs moved at 04.30 to H.19 C 88. where they remained | |

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| LINE | | | Having reached the final objective, consolidation was immediately started by all companies. During the consolidation companies were subjected to a good deal of sniping and Machine Gun fire. No 2 company formed a defensive flank into our front and No 3 company formed from a defensive flank to the No 2 by left rear. No 4 company dug in about 200 yds from the X roads in W 19 b facing N. and N.E. | APPENDIX MAP C |
| | | | When the 3rd Bde came up on our left No 4 company dug on roughly on a line from W. 19 b 82 to W 19 b 48. As soon as possible to change the disposition of the troops of Nos 2 and 3 coys who were forming a defensive flank every assist dash coys to sniping the 2 front coys consolidated the line of the final objectives as their main line of defence with posts about 200 yds in front of this line. No 3 coy consolidated a line immediately E of the old German front line Trenches. | |

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| LINE | | | Most of the casualties occurred during the consolidation when stretcher bearers had to get right up to the front line and all the wounded have evacuated under cover of darkness. The evacuation of the wounded was made very difficult owing to the continued sniping. The Stretcher bearers worked untiringly and all the wounded have evacuated most expeditiously.<br>The Sniping and Machine Gun fire has been a marked feature of the 3rd Bde on our Left, But communication to the front lots by day has been extremely difficult.<br>The Line taken up by B- H.Qrs and the area occupied by No 4 Company has shelled almost incessantly the whole day by guns of all Calibres from 06.00 - 16.00. But owing to everyone having dug in Casualties have been few. CAPT & ADJT. J. B. KEENAN being the only casualty on B- H.Q's.<br>There was not much shelling of the 3 front companies during the day the right forward party suffering except for a few shots and shell bursts in front of the Main SOLESMES - VALENCIENNES road and the area about B- H.Qrs<br>The 2nd/3rd COLDSTREAM Gds moved up in Reserve to the 2 front Bns and two | APPENDIX MAP C |

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| LINE | | | Chiefly responsible for the protection the right flank of the 2nd B. GRENADIER GDS<br>For time table of advance of the 62nd Div who were attacking on the Right of<br>the 2nd L.F. see artillery Barrage Map. It will be noted that army to<br>SOLESMES having to be protected by their attack was much slower. | APPENDIX<br>MAP "C" |
| | 21/10/18 | 01.00 | No 1 and 2 Coys sent out patrols to report on the River HARPIES, and to establish<br>a line of posts close to the river in order to be able to keep it under observation. These<br>Patrols met with a good deal of Machine Gun rifle & shell fire at close range, but no casualties<br>occurred. They reported the River to be from 6 to 8 feet wide and 2 to 4 ft deep.<br>A line of posts was established along the whole front varying from 100 to 250 yrs<br>from the River.<br>No 1 Coy had to swing their right back slightly, owing<br>to the 2nd Bn GRENADIER GDS being held up by Machine Guns from the Village<br>in N. 14 d 8.4.<br>The day passed fairly quietly. There was slight shelling of Bn H.Qrs and the<br>Main line of Defence of the 2 front Coys. Enemy aircraft was also very active and<br>it was not possible to locate the forward platoons by day.<br>The 2nd Bn COLDSTREAM GDS came into billets during the afternoon to SOLESMES in<br>St HILAIRE. The Relief of the 2 front Bn actual was completed did not take place. | |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| LINE | 27/10/18 | | It rained heavily for about 2 hours during the morning, which made trenches very bad again. The men were relieved during the time they left their billets in ST HILAIRE by the 2nd and then had to relieve battalions of the 2nd Infantry. It was very cold at night. It is hoped that the 5th could not be attacked, orders were issued for No 4 Company to relieve No 2 Company and No 3 to relieve No 1 Company. No 1 and 2 Coys to return to the accomodation vacated by No 3 and 4 Coys respectively. These reliefs were changed before the Company Commanders concerned and were completed without Coy passing Starting by 21.00. The day was very quiet and very little shelling on the B[n] front all the 15[th] B[n] was relieved in the evening by the 2nd/5th Royal Fusiliers 2nd Division 2½ companies taking over the trenches held by 4 companies the remaining 1½ Coys relieving the 2nd B[n] Grenadier Gds. 2 Guides per Platoon were sent to Bridge 9 over the SEULE where the leading Company of the relieving B[n] arrived about 17.15 hours owing to the difficulty of relieving the front posts in the daylight, the relief took longer than expected. Relief "complete" not being reported by all Coys till 21.30 | APPENDIX MAP C |

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18.

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| LINE & CARNIERES | | | On completion of Relief Battalion proceeded independently to the Assembly Point D.5.C. 5.8. Three Companies were conveyed by 13th Motor Lorries, to CARNIERES leaving about 23.00 and arriving about 23.45. All arrangements for Billets had been made by the Detailed Billeting Party | |
| | | | Joined CAPT. L.D.M. H.H. HICKIE rejoined 13th from ENGLAND. | |
| | | | At 7.15 Battalion marched for the 20th Bde Area, the 13th Bde relieved here | |

| KILLED | | WOUNDED | | MISSING | | DIED OF WOUNDS | | TOTAL | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| O. | O.R. | O. | O.R. | O. | O.R. | O | O.R | O. | O.R. |
| NIL | 10 | 1 | 42 | NIL | 2 | NIL | 2 | 1 | 56 |

The following Officers took part in the operations

No. 1 Coy.
CAPT. A.N.L. PAGET M.C.
Lt. J.C. HAYDON
A.E. TAYLOR.

No. 2 Coy.
Lieut. E.M. HARVEY M.C.
Lt. J.T. TODD
H.N.L. KOCH de GOOREYND

No. 3 Company
CAPT. G.L.S.C. BRIDGE M.C.
Lt. J.J.B. BRADY
Lt. G.E.F. VAN DE WEYER

No. 4 Company:
Lt. F.R. BALDWIN
A.E. HUTCHINSON M.C.
A.N. C.A. BARNWELL

13th H.Q.
MAJOR H.E. GORDON M.C.
CAPT J.D. KEENAN
C.A.J. VERNON

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| CARNIERES | 23/10/18 | | The day was spent in cleaning up billets and all companies had inspections of clothing and equipment.<br>Lt-Col R.R.C. BAGGALLAY M.C. returned from leave and assumed command of the 5th R. Berks R. in absence of the Brigadier on Peace Leave.<br>CAPT D.W. GUNSTON M.C. joined Bn for duty.<br>Hot Tea, Iced Buns and clean clothing was issued.<br>Companies were at the disposal of Company Commanders for Drill etc.<br>The cleaning up of Billets was continued. | |
| " | 24/10/18 | | Companies were at the disposal of Company Commanders for Company training.<br>A Field Service Tea served out by all Coys.<br>Bn paraded at 01.30 for Gas Drill under the R.S.M. | |
| " | 25/10/16 | | Companies were at the disposal of Company Commanders for Company training.<br>The Bde Brigadier held Parade during the morning. | |
| " | 26/10/18 | | Usual Divine Services were held. | |
| " | 27/10/18 | | | |

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*(Erase heading not required.)*

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| CARNIERES | 28/10/18. | 10.00 | 15th was inspected by the G.O.C. GUARDS DIVISION. After inspection that battn carried out close formation march at the disposal of the Coy Comdrs for Drill etc. | |
| | 29/10/18. | | Companies at the disposal of Coy Comdrs for Revised Guard Scheme. A draft of 91 O.R. joined 15th for duty. | |
| | 30/10/18. | | Companies at the disposal of Coy Comdrs for Outpost scheme. Whilst the 15th were at CARNIERES a Coy Football match took place between No 4 Coy but No 2 Coy No 1 Coy but No 3 Coy and No 4 but No 1 Company. | |
| | 31/10/18. | | 15th marched to ST HILAIRE via BOUSSIERES leaving at 11.35 and arriving 13.05. Coy Billets from the 3rd GG in the Factory in D. 1. a. | |

G. F. Soda Major
Comdg 15th D.L.I.

Lieut & Adjt

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|

Major A. F. L. Gordon. M. C. Joined Battn. for duty 30-9-18
Lieut. G. E. F. Van der Voot. - do - 2-10-18
" H. E. Van der Voot. - do - 2-10-18
2/Lt. G. M. Tylden-Wright. - do - 4-10-18
" A. L. W. Koch de Gooreynd. - do - 4-10-18
" V. J. S. French. - do - 4-10-18
" Hon. C. A. Barnewall. - do - 4-10-18
" A. E. Taylor. - do - 6-10-18
Capt. & Q.M. H. Hickie. M. C. - do - 22-10-18
" D. W. Gunston. M. C. - do - 24-10-18
Lieut. A. L. Bain. - do - 25-10-18
~~2/Lt. G. M. Tylden-Wright.~~
Capt. Hon. W. S. P. Alexander. D. S. O. Leave to U.K. 19-9-18 to 3-10-18
" A. W. L. Paget. M. C. - do - 28-9-18 to 12-10-18
Lieut. D. S. Browne. - do - 29-9-18 to 13-10-18
Lieut. D. E. Young. RAMC attc. - do - 18-10-18 to 1-11-18
2/Lt. P. R. J. Barry. - do - 19-10-18 to 2-11-18
Capt. D. J. Hegarty. M. C. - do - Paris 19-10 to 26-10-18
Lieut. L. D. Murphy. - do - " 19-10 to 26-10-18
Lt. Col. R. R. C. Baggallay. M. C. - do - U.K. 5-10-18 to 21-10-18
Lieut. H. A. A. Collett. - do - " 2-10-18 to 16-10-18
2/Lt. J. C. Haydon. - do - " 29-10-18 to 13-11-18
Lieut. J. J. B. Brady. Course of Instrn. at G.H.Q. Lewis Gun School 26-10-18.
2/Lt. E. H. R. Burke. Course of Instrn. at VI Corps Lewis Gun School 14-10-18.
Capt. C. A. J. Vernon. Leave to ~~Paris~~ U.K. 29-9-18 to 13-10-18
2/Lt. O. R. Baldwin. Attc. 1st Gds. Bde. T.M. Batty. 26-9-18 to 15-10-18.

11 Officers Joined for duty during month.
156 O.R. - do - - do -

Lieut. V. J. S. French. Killed in Action 10-10-18
Capt. & Adjt. J. B. Keenan. Wounded in Action 20-10-18.
Lieut. M. M. Henderson. - do - 11-10-18
Lieut. R. L. Dagger. Struck off Strength 3-10-18 on proceeding to England to resume medical studies.
2/Lt. T. B. Maughan. Struck off Strength, medically unfit. 18-10-18.
Lieut. L. D. Murphy. Admitted to Hosptl. 28-10-18
2/Lt. Hon. C. A. Barnewall. - do - 29-10-18.

21 O.R. Killed in Action.
6 " Died of Wounds.
63 " Wounded in Action.
3 " Missing.
42 " Evac (ill)
8 " Struck off Strength.
1 " Deserted.
144

| | Officers. | O.R. |
|---|---|---|
| Approximate Strength on 1-10-18. | 25 | 856 |
| Joined during month:- | 11 | 156 |
| | 36 | 1,012 |
| Left during month:- | 5 | 144 |
| Approximate Strength on 31-10-18:- | 31 | 868 |

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SECRET.

# 1st Battalion Irish Guards

## DEFENCE SCHEME SUPPORT BATTALION.

REF:- 57c N.E. 1/20000.

18th September 1918.

APPENDIX A.

Organization & Boundaries

(a) The Brigade boundary is held by 1 Battn. in the Line, 1 Battn. in Support, & 1 Battn in Reserve.

(b) The Brigade boundaries may be copied from Mapat Battn. H.Q.

(c) 2nd Guards Brigade are on the Right & 155th Infantry Brigade on the Left.

System of Defence

(a) The main line of defence is the Red Line (old British Front Line) from J.5.b.4.4 to D.22.d.6.3.

(b) East of this an Outpost System held in depth with Outpost line of Resistance on Green Line (see mapat Battn. H.Q).

Dispositions in case of attack

The 1st Battn. Irish Guards (Support Battn) will be responsible for defence of RED LINE, which will be held at all costs.

No 2 Coy. from Junction of FISH AVENUE & old British Front Line J.5.b.4.4 to Junction with 2nd Coldstream Guards Reserve Coy. at SPRAT POST with 2 Platoons, one Platoon in FISH AVENUE & one in Support in SHARK SUPPORT.

No 3 Coy. Old British Front Line from Junction with RABBIT ALLEY, D.29.a.6.3. to Junction with RAT ALLEY, D.22.d.65.30. Three Platoons in Front Line & one in Support in ROBIN SUPPORT.

Nos 4 & 1 Coys. will Stand-to in present positions & await orders.

No 4 Coy. will be prepared to occupy that portion of RED LINE at present occupied by Reserve Coy. of Front Battn (2nd Battn. Coldstream Guards) D.29.a.8.1 to SPRAT POST should that Coy be moved forward.

No 1 Coy will be prepared to counter-attack or form a defensive flank.

O.C.s Nos 1 & 4 Coys. will see that their Platoon Commanders & a certain number of N.C.O.s know the ground & position of other Coys. & Reserve Coy. 2nd Coldstream Guards.

Battn. H.Q. will remain in present position, D.21.d.0.5.

(4) Normal positions

Under normal conditions Coys. will remain in their present dispositions except No 3 Coy. who will always keep one section of each of their ~~Platoons~~ 3 Platoons who are detailed for RED LINE in RED LINE

Copies to:-
All Coys (1-4)
Brigade H.Q. (5)
2nd Bn Coldstream Gds (6)
Retained (7-8)

Rowan Baggallay
Lieut Colonel
Comdg 1st Battn Irish Guards

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# WAR DIARY
or
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
(Erase heading not required.)

NOVEMBER, 1918.

Army Form C. 2118.

(1)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| St HILAIRE | 1 XI 18 | | The Bde remained in billets in St HILAIRE | |
| BERMERAIN | 2 XI 18 | 12.30 p.m. | The Bde marched to BERMERAIN via St PYTHON and St MARTIN - 9½ miles. The weather was bad, a drizzling rain falling most of the time. Bde HQ and 2 Corps (No 3 Hd Corps) were billeted in BERMERAIN and 2 Corps between CAPELLE and BERMERAIN in bivouacs. The Bde was all in billets and bivouacs by 6.30 pm. The traffic & blocking on the roads was very bad & made progress slow. The C.O. attended a Conference at Bde HQ at 6 pm at CAPELLE | VALENCIENNES map. |
| do | do | 3 XI 18 | A fine day. The Bde remained in billets & bivouacs. Orders for the attack on the next day were issued to Bde from Bde HQ at about 5 pm. but owing to the enemy withdrawing on both flanks & slightly on the front these orders were altered again during the night & not finally settled until just after midnight. (Copy of Bde orders giving objectives & tasks attached & marked appendix B. map marked appendix C.) The 2nd Bde COLDSTREAM GDS were in the line & to take the Blue & Green lines, the 2nd Bde Green Gde to pass through these on Green line & take Red line & push on beyond. The 1st Bde Irish Guards to follow in support & Grenadiers. | |

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# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
*(Erase heading not required.)*

Army Form C. 2118.

(2)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| The Advance | 4/XI/18. | | The day was beautifully fine. The Bde passed the Starting point at the cemetery on the BERMERAIN - RUESNES road punctually according to Bde Orders and proceeded along route as laid down in para 5. of Bde Operation Order. as far as MORTY FARM. While going under the railway the first hostile Shell fell. The Bde halted for 10 mins. by copse in R.2.d. just on side of the road. The 3rd Bde Gren. Gds and 1st Bde Scots GDS were between the Bde and the 2nd Gren Gds which caused some anxiety to the C.O. for fear of not getting touch with 2nd Bde Gren. Gds. Almost immediately after passing LA CROISETTE Shells began to fall rather close & frequent from H.V. guns. At the point on the road R.11.a.7.1 the Bde halted again to take the L. guns off the limbers as the bridge was broken across the river at VILLERS POL & wheel transport could get no further. The limbers were ordered to remain there until the bridge was repaired & then get touch again with Bde. While this was being done the 1st Bde Scots Gds passed through us but of course formed they could not cross both their limbers & so while they were getting their guns off the Bde went through them again. On getting to the crossing the shelling Heard had been on the road & bridge luckily ceased | |

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# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
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Army Form C. 2118.

(3)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 4/11/18. | | The last man of the 3rd Gr. Gds was just going over & the Bde was able to commence crossing straight away. It was slow progress as only one man crossed at a time being assisted up the bank by German prisoners. As the Bde got to the cross roads LES QUARTRE VENTS there was a good deal of shelling but by marvellous luck no casualties. At L. 26. c. the Bde halted & got into artillery | |
| | | 8.45 a.m. | formation. There was more shelling here & a few casualties sustained. Going over the crest by the enclosure long range M.G. fire was encountered. The Bde proceeded on as far as about G. 32. c. 7. 8 when it was found that the 2/Grenadiers were held up by M.G. fire. The Grenadier leading coys were in G. 33 central & just N. of the wood in G. 33. a. There was a certain amount of M.G. fire coming over Bde & a little shelling. The platoons at once dug in where they were. After being there about an hour as enemy T.M. opened direct fire from some where about G. 32. d. 9.9! firing about a dozen rounds & killing 8 or 9 horses in R.E. dragging wagons & guns horses - also causing the Bde a few casualties. Lt A. L. BAIN was killed. The situation remained unchanged on our immediate front until late in the afternoon. The troops on our left were | |

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(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form C. 2118.

(4)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | apparently unable to get on ~~[illegible]~~ but the 2nd Gds Bde on our right gradually got on during afternoon. | |
| | | 4.30 p.m. | At 4.30 pm. the Bn was ordered to advance through the 2/ Grenr. Gds. the 2nd Gds. Bde being across stream on our right & getting to S. outskirts | |
| | | 4.45 pm. | of PREUX-AU-SART. No 1 Coy was at once ordered forward preceded by a strong patrol - No 3 Coy followed in Support. No 4 Coy about 400 yds behind No 3 Coy. No 2 Coy remained where it was. Skirting the S. point of the wood in G. 33. c. No 1 Coy crossed the stream at G. 33. d. 9.5. Bn H.Q. crossed just behind rear platoon of No 1 Coy. No 3 crossed a little N. as they were ordered to follow No 1 Coy slightly echeloned to their left to protect that flank as the situation there was v. obscure. The stream was a slight obstacle as it was boggy at the bottom & had steep overhanging banks of about 4 feet. The men crossed on stretchers laid across. It was now almost dark & the undergrowth exceedingly thick. Nos 1 & 3 Coys halted on the top of the very steep slope on the 100 Contour. No 4 Coy remained at the foot. There had been no opposition beyond a little shelling. A patrol was sent forward & got touch with the 3d/ Grenr. Gds forward post at X roads M. 5. a. 5.9. Eventually No 1 Coy held orchards on | |

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# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
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Army Form C. 2118.

(5).

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | E. side of road from G. 35 c 5.7 (on left of 3/G.G.) to G. 35. a. 6.4 & No 3 Coy from there left to G. 35. a. 5.9 & patrolled up to road junction G. 29. c. 9.9. to try & get touch with troops on left; which was eventually established. No 4 Coy was established on line of road G. 35. c. 2.8 to G. 34. b. 4.2. No 2 Coy was brought up to sunk road G. 33. d 2.5. This was all done in pitch dark & was v. difficult owing to orchards & very high thick hedges. Bde H.Q. moved to 3/G.G Bde HQ at M. 4. a. 2.2. as there was a telephone line to Bde H.Q. Throughout the night there was very heavy shelling on 3 forward Coys & Bde H.Q. No 1 Coy. killed a few Germans | |
| PREUX-AU-SART (LE WARPE) | 5 XI 18. | 6 am. | The 2nd Bde Scots Gds passed through our line & continued the advance, & the Bde came out of the Slits & were billeted in the village. The inhabitants on coming out of their cellars in the morning were delighted to find British troops again & showed the greatest cordiality. They themselves were v. comfortable as the village was v. little damaged. During the day the village was shelled at intervals. Bde H.Q. at G. 35. c. 5.8. Rained all day | |
| do. | 6 XI 18 | | Heavy rain all day. Bde remained where it was. A certain amount of shelling - rather more than previous day. all the windows at Bde H.Q were broken by one shell. | |

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# WAR DIARY
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# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
*(Erase heading not required.)*

Army Form C. 2118.

(6)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| BAVAI. | 7 XI 18 | | The Bn marched at 3.15 pm to BAVAI. Roads v. heavy & muddy and a light drizzle was falling. Route LE BRACMAR, AMFROIPRET, BERMERIES. The railway bridge was destroyed blocking the road in H. 30.a. & a detour had to be made through the station. The forked roads in I. 25.a. where destroyed by a huge crater and a ramp had to be dug to enable heavy Gun limbers & cookers to get round it. The billeting area for the Brigade having been changed during the march there was no billeting party to meet Bn & no arrangements had been made. The town was being shelled. The Bn arrived at railway at 5 pm & it was almost dark. The area allotted to Bn was LOUVIGNIES BAVAI (a Southern suburb). Areas were hastily allotted to Coys who quickly got into houses & were v. comfortable. Luckily no casualties were sustained from shelling. The 2nd Line transport remained at Chateau grounds at H. 30.a. being unable to negotiate the many huge craters in the town. | Sheet 51 1/40,000 |
| BAVAI | 8 XI 18 | | The Bn remained in billets until midnight. There was a Conference for Cmdg. Offrs. at Bde. H.Q. during afternoon re. operations for ensuing day. The 2nd Gds Bde. were in front line and held the line approx of the railway | |

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# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

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(7)

Army Form C. 2118.

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| MAUBEUGE | 9/X/18 | | in P.6 & J.36. The first Guards Bde. was to pass through on this line at 5. am. & capture MAUBEUGE & consolidate on high ground in Q 5 & K 35. The Bde was to lead on right & 2/C. Guards on left. Dividing line being grid line running due E. between K 31 & Q 1 etc<br>The Bde passed starting point at 12.20 am. when FEIGNIES road enters BAVAI.<br>The Bde marched as a Bde accompanied by L.G. limbers. Route via La LONGUEVILLE & LES MOTTES to X roads by School in P.4 Central. There was a little shelling on road just W. of LES MOTTES & again just E. of it. The Bde was halted at X roads P.4 Central. The Lewis guns were taken off the limbers at LES MOTTES owing to the limbers being unable to pass a mine crater on eastern edge of village. The coy. H.Q. of companies of 2nd Gds. Bde in line were at X roads & information was received that patrols of 3/Gr. Gds had penetrated into MAUBEUGE without opposition. Some m.g. fire was sweeping across X roads from Somewhere in P.5.d. No 2 Coy was sent forward to railway & No 4 Coy to P.5. Central. Move along road to right to X roads at railway | |

(A7098). Wt. W12859/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

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# WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118.

(2)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| MAUBEUGE | 9 XI 18 | | at P. 6. c. 9. 1. 5ª 5. am these coys were ordered to advance, Nº 2 Coy along main road & Nº 4 along road running just S. of main road & roughly parallel to it. In P. 6. d. Nº 4 Coy ran into a Company of Germans retiring & a short sharp fight ensued in which 5 enemy were wounded and 12 captured. The remainder got away in the dark. Nº 2 Coy captured two prisoners soon after crossing railway. Nº 1 & 3 Coys followed in support along main road. Bde H.Q. followed Nº 2 Coy. The companies passed through Maubeuge without opposition & established themselves on line as ordered, about 8.30 am Bde H.Q. were at PONT ALLANT K. 32. d. 0. 0. The line was reorganised 1 Nº 2 Coy sent on to ASSEVENT with a picquet on destroyed bridge over river at K. 36. d. 5. 0 a line of observation by day in L. 31. c. 7 one platoon in support in village. Nº 4 Coy. held posts in L. 35 d. (S. of road) & Q 5. 6. down to river. Nº 1 & 3 Coys were in Res. on Eastern edge of Q. 4. d. Yeomanry & Corps cyclists were out in front. | |

(A9094). Wt. W12839/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(Erase heading not required.)

(9)

Army Form C. 2118.

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| MAUBEUGE | 10 XI 18 to 11 XI 18 | | The Bn remained in same disposition. There was a little shelling in ASSEVANT + E. outskirts of village<br>An armistice was declared at 11 am. | |
| " | 12 XI 18 | | The Bn was relieved by 2/ G.Gds + moved into billets in the FAUBOURG de MONS. | |
| MAUBEUGE (FAUBOURG DE MONS) | 13 XI 18 to 15 XI 18 | | The Bn remained in billets on 14th a big Thanksgiving Service was held in the Church at MAUBEUGE for Civilians + military. The Bn marched to the Service + provided the Guard of Honour at the altar + also lined the PLACE d'ARMES during presentation of a flag by the mayor to the Major General. | NAMUR MAP |
| VILLERS-SIRE-NICOLE | 16 XI 18 | | The Bn Commenced its march to Germany. H--- formed part of a "Sub-group" of pioneers + engineers going on ahead. The Bn marched with an advanced guard at 1.30 pm via BETTIGNIES about 5½ miles to VILLERS-SIRE-NICOLE. + billeted there for the night. | |

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(*Erase heading not required.*)

Army Form C. 2118.

(10)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| BINCHE. | 17 XI 18. | | The march was continued to BINCHE. No 3 Coy formed the advanced Guard to the column & passing through the town formed an outpost line with pickets at X roads 1 mile S. of railway on BINCHE – MERBES Ste MARIE road with a detached post on BINCHE – BUVEINNES road, a piquet on X roads ~~S.~~ S. of T in TRIEU on CHARLEROI road and piquet on X roads 1/4 mile W. of R in RESSAIX. Remainder of Bn was billeted just west of the Station. The Bn received a great ovation on marching in. | |
| BINCHE. | 18 XI 18. | | The Bn remained in BINCHE. No 2 Coy relieved No 3 Coy in O.P. line at 11.30 am. The weather after being fine + frosty for a week broke to a drizzle in afternoon. Distance 9½ miles | |
| LE TRIEUX [CHARLEROI] | 19 XI 18 | | The march was continued to CHARLEROI. The Battn passing the starting point at 08.00 hours. No 4 Coy formed the advance guard to the Battn and passing through CHARLEROI and LE TRIEUX formed an outpost line with piquets on Bridge over the SAMBRE RIVER ¾ mile South of the ~~[illegible]~~ M in MONTIGNIES, a piquet at the road junction just South of the 2nd R in CHARLEROI and a piquet at the X roads just South of the S in BENSON. a piquet at the road junction just North of S in GENSON. Two platoons of No 1 Coy | |

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(*Erase heading not required.*)

Army Form C. 2118.

(11)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| CHARLEROI (LE TRIEUX.) | 20 XI 18 | | Billetted in CHARLEROI and provided piquets on the each of the three Bridges which span the River SAMBRE in the Town. The Remainder of the Batt were billetted in LE TRIEUX about a mile East of CHARLEROI. Billets were reached about 1·15 pm (13·15 hours). Distance of March about 13 miles. The weather was misty but warm. The roads being very slippery & bad for marching. The Batt had a great reception in CHARLEROI. The Drums feeding some difficulty in forcing their way through the great & enthusiastic crowds.<br>The Batt remained in Billets. The weather was foggy. During the evening Piquets of No 4 Coy arrested three German soldiers disguised as Civilians | |
| (LE TRIEUX) | 21 XI 18 | | The Batt remained in Billets. No 4 Coy was relieved in the outpost line by No 2 Coy 2nd Batt Coldstream Guards. No 4 Coy reached Billets at about 11·45 pm. Massed Drums of the 1st and 2nd Guards Brigades played in CHARLEROI at 4 pm. Weather fine but cold | |
| (LE TRIEUX) | 22 XI 18 | | The Batt remained in Billets. The two Platoon of No 1 Coy guarding the Bridges in CHARLEROI were withdrawn at 9 am. Weather fine and a little warmer. | |

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

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Army Form C. 2118.

(12)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| SART St LAURENT | 23 XI 18 | | The March was continued to SART St LAURENT. The Batn paraded at 7.30 a.m. & passed its starting point x roads due South of M in MONTIGNIES at 8 a.m. Route - CHATELET - PRESLE - VITRIVAL - FOSSE - SART St LAURENT. The Batn met with the usual enthusiastic reception all along its Route. The Maya of SART St LAURENT headed by a large BELGIAN Flag came out to meet the Batn & marched in at the head of its Batn. No 3 Coy formed the advance Guard & passing through the village held an outpost line with picquets on all roads running North and East from SART St LAURENT. The weather was frosty but beautifully fine with a warm sun. Billets were reached at 1.50 p.m. Distance of March 15 miles | |
| NANINNE | 24 XI 18 | | The March was continued to NANINNES. The Batn passing starting point Road junction in SART St LAURENT at 9 a.m. Route SART St LAURENT - BOIS DE VILLERS - WEPION - DAVE - NANINNE. No 2 Coy formed the advance Guard and passing through NANINNE took up an outpost line with picquets on roads running North and East from NANINNE. The Belts received the usual cordial reception all along the Route. At BOIS DE VILLERS the Batn passed 84 GERMAN GUNS of all calibres left behind as a part of the guns to be handed over accordg to the terms of the armistice. At 11.10 a.m a large tract of heavily wooded country was passed, this was evidently intended for the MEUSE LINE. 11.45 a.m. The Batn crossed the MEUSE at WEPION by | |

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(13)

(*Erase heading not required.*)

Army Form C. 2118.

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | a Pontoon bridge, The Drums playing the Regimental March. The MEUSE RIVER is here a very wide flowing between high cliffs. From here the road ascended rapidly to NANINNE. The Batn reached billets at 12.55 pm. The country passed through rapidly changed from the low flatish coal district to a fine hilly & wooded Country. Weather beautifully fine but cold. Distance of march. 10¾ miles | |
| GESVES | 25 XI 18 | | The march was resumed to GESVES. The Batn passing the starting point - The STATION WEST of NANINNE at 9.0 a.m. Nos Coy supplying the advance guard. Route - GESVES - KINAUX then S.E down the main LUXEMBOURG ROAD — GORIOULE - SORINNE LA LONGUE. Here it was intended to billet. But on arrival it was discovered that the village was full of disease. Permission having been obtained from the C.R.E who was at SART. BERNARD, the Batn having had dinners paraded at 2.45 pm and resumed the march to GESVES. Billets were reached at 3.50 pm. Batn H.Q were billetted in the Chateau which had been sacked about 15 days previously by BOLSHEVIC SOLDIERS. The weather broke early in the day settled down to light rain. Distance 9 miles. Coys Billetted in the NORTH. EAST AND SOUTH areas of the village but out picquets guarding the respective roads. | MARCHE MAP |

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

*(Erase heading not required.)*

Army Form C. 2118.

(14)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| SORÉE | 26 XI 18 | | The March was continued to SORÉE. The Batt passing the starting point the Church in GESVES at 8.30 a.m. The Batt was to have marched to HAVELANGE but at the last moment orders were received to proceed to SORÉE instead. The alteration was on account of the difficulties of Supply. Route GESVES – FRANCESSE – SORÉE Billets were reached at 9.40 a.m. Distance 2½ miles. The weather was threatening but rain held off. The Major General visited the Commanding OFFICER at 12 noon. On arrival piquets were put out on the EASTERN EXITS of the village. | |
| SORÉE | 27 XI 18 | | The Batt remained in billets all day. Weather was bad. Rain all morning but cleared up in the afternoon. | |
| SORÉE | 28 XI 18 | | The Batt remained in billets. The supplies for the first train in the morn failed to arrive. The Quartermaster managed to improvise breakfast for the Batt. Supplies arrived at 10 a.m. Weather unsettled with slight showers. | |
| SORÉE | 29 XI 18 | | The Batt remained in billets. The time being spent in Drill. Cleaning up & inspection by Coy Commanders. The Batt were able to make use of improvised baths. Weather dull but no rain. | |
| SORÉE | 30 XI 18 | | | |

Robert Bagnall Lt Col
Cmdg. 1/5th Bn 1st Guards

1-XII-18

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| | |
|---|---|
| 2/Lieut. E.H.R. Burke. | Completed Course of Instrn at VI Corps Lewis Gun School 4-11-18. |
| 2/Lt. H.G. Darby. | Completed Course of Instrn. at VI Corps Infantry School 4-11-18. |
| 2/Lt. J.J.B. Brady. | Course of Instrn. at G.H.Q. Lewis Gun School 26-10-18 to 16-11-18. |
| Lieut. D.E. Young. R.A.M.C. | Ceased to be attached to 1st Battn. Irish Guards as Medical Officer 15-11-18. |
| Lieut. E.B. Spafford. | Granted leave to U.K. 2-11-18 to 16-11-18. |
| 2/Lt. O.R. Baldwin. | - do - 2-11-18 to 16-11-18. |
| 2/Lt. A.E. Hutchinson. | - do - 3-11-18 to 17-11-18. |
| 2/Lt. J.J.B. Brady. | - do - 26-11-18 to 10-12-18. |
| 2/Lt. A.L.W. Koch de Gooreynd. | Granted leave to Paris from 23-11-18 to 1-12-18. |
| Capt. G.K. Thompson. M.C. | To England 19-10-18 (21 days Sick leave) |
| Capt. J.E. Cheesman. R.A.M.C. | Attached to 1st Battn. Irish Guards as Medical Officer from 15-11-18. |
| 3655. D. Sgt. G. Murphy. | Joined Battn, for duty 20-11-18. |

23 O.R. joined during month.

| | Officers. | O.R. |
|---|---|---|
| Approximate Strength 1-11-18. :- | 31 | 868 |
| Joined during month :- | - | 23 |
| | 31 | 891 |
| Left during month :- | 5 | 90 |
| Approximate Strength 30-11-18 :- | 26 | 801 |

| | |
|---|---|
| Major A.F.L. Gordon. M.C. | Struck off Strength on proceeding to 2nd Battn. Irish Guards 6-11-18. |
| Capt. Hon. W.S.P. Alexander. D.S.O. | Struck off Strength on proceeding to 2nd Battn. Irish Guards 16-11-18. |
| 2/Lt. Hon. C.A. Barnewall. | Struck off Strength on being evacuated to England (sick) 5-11-18. |
| Lieut. A.L. Bain. | Killed in Action 4-11-18. |
| Lieut. F.S.L. Smith. M.C. | Wounded in Action 4-11-18. |
| 2/Lt. H.A.A. Collett. M.C. | Admitted to Hospital 9-11-18. |
| 918. R.S.M. T. Cahill. | Struck off Strength on proceeding to England to take over vacancy as R.S.M. Guards Depot 2-11-18. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 4 | O.R. | Killed in Action during month. |
| 19 | " | Wounded - do - - do - |
| 3 | " | Struck off Strength - do - |
| 64 | " | Evacuated (ill) - do - |
| 90 | | |

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

1st Bn IRISH GUARDS

WAR DIARY
or
INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form C. 2118.

WO 95/1216/1

December, 1918.

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lieut D.A.B. MOODIE, M.C. | | | Joined Bn for duty 30-11-18 | Lieut (A/Capt) G.K. THOMPSON, M.C. Struck off Strength (medically unfit) Auth. D.R.O. No 4185 d/3-12-18 | |
| Lieut. H.A.A. COLLETT, M.C. | | | Discharged Hospital 29-11-18 | | |
| 2/Lt. E.C. FITZCLARENCE | | | Joined Bn for duty 14-12-18 | | |
| Lieut H.M. HENDERSON | | | — " — 20-12-18 | 44 Other Ranks Struck off Strength during month | |
| Lieut. D.A.B. MOODIE, M.C. | | | Duty in Eng. as escort to Colours 23-12-18 to | 101 — " — Evacuated (ill) — " — | |
| 2/Lt. G.M. TYNDEN-WRIGHT | | | — " — | 145 | |
| Capt. G.St.C. BAMBRIDGE, M.C. | | | Granted leave to U.K. 30-12-18 to 13-1-19. | | |
| 2/Lt E.H.R. BURKE | | | — " — 30-12-18 to 13-1-19. | | |
| 2/Lt. G.F. TODD | | | — " — 1-1-19 to 15-1-19. | | |
| 174 Other Ranks joined during month. | | | | | |

| | Officers | O. Ranks |
|---|---|---|
| Approx. Strength 1-12-18 | 26 | 801 |
| Joined during month | 3 | 174 |
| | 29 | 975 |
| Left during month | 1 | 145 |
| Approx. Strength 31-12-18 | 28 | 830 |

(A9175) Wt W2335/P760 600,000 12/17 D. D. & L. Sch 32a. Forms/C2118/15

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# WAR DIARY or INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

1st Batn Irish Guards (1)

Army Form C. 2118.

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| SOREE | 1 XII 18<br>2 XII 18<br>3 XII 18<br>4 XII 18 | | The Batn remained in Billets & spent the time in Company Drill. Inspections. The weather was dull with frequent showers. | MARCHE 1 |
| MEAN | 5 XII 18 | | The March was resumed to day. The Batn again coming under the orders of the 1st Guards Brigade. The Batn marched off at 9 a.m. No 3 Coy leading. Route - SOREE - EVELETT - HAVELANGIE - VERLEE - MEFF - MEAN. Billets reached 1.40 p.m. Distance of March 12½ Miles. Roads muddy. The country passed through was very fine wooded & hilly country. Weather very fine. | |
| VILLERS ST BERTRUDE | 6 XII 18 | | The March was continued at 8.50 AM today. No 2 Coy leading. Transports country was again passed through. 2nd Line and 1st Line Transport were Brigaded with the exception of Cookers and Lewis gun limbers which marched behind their companies. Weather very fine. Billets reached 2.30 p.m. Distance of March 14 miles. ROUTE - MEAN - PETIT HAN - CARVAUX - HEYD - AISNE - VILLERS ST. BERTRUDE. | |

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(A10066) Wt W5300/P713 750,000 2/18 Sch. 52 Forms/C2118/16

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1st Rl Irish Guards

# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(2)

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| LIERNEUX | 7 XII 18 | | The March was continued at at 8.90 A.M to day. Route - VILLERS Ste GERTRUDE — LES ANNAIS — MANHAY — VAUX CHAVANNE — JEVIGNE — LIERNEUX. The road for the first two hours was uphill all the way. From MANHAY to LIERNEUX the road was very bad and was quite without any metal. The mud being really bad. Weather threatening but rain held off. Billets reached at 2.40 PM. Distance of March 15 miles. A very tiring march. The men marched very well. | |
| LIERNEUX | 8 XII 18<br>9 XII 18<br>10 XII 18 | | The Batt remained in Billets and spent the time in inspection & Company Drill etc. | |
| RECHT | 11 XI 18 | | The Batt resumed the March to day at 9.15 a.m. Route - ~~RECHT~~ LIERNEUX — MENIL — GORONNE — REMOUCHEUX — VIELSALM — VILLE DU BOIS — PETITTHIER — POTEAU — RECHT. The Frontier was crossed at POTEAU. ROUTE The Drums played the Batt | |

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(A10266) Wt W5300/P713 750,000 2/18 Sch. 52 Forms/C2118/16

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1st Bn Irish Guards

# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(4)

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| KELDENICH | 14 XII 18 | | The Batt continued the March to day at 8 a.m. Route – BLUMENTHAL – REIFFERSEHELD – SISTIG – SOTENICH – KALL – KELDENICH. Billets were reached at 12 noon. Distance 10 miles. Though hostilities were threatening rain held off till the Batt entered Billets. The country now began to change as the mountainous country was left behind. The Batt had a very stiff climb from KARC – KELDENICH which stands upon a high Hill. The Batt much appreciated the Slate marker after the rather tiring ~~day~~ marches just accomplished | |
| ROGGENDORF | 15 XII 18 | | The Batt resumed continued the March at 9 a.m. today. Route – KELDENICH – KALL – ROGGENDORF. Billets were reached at 10.35 a.m. Distance 5 miles. Roads good. Weather dull but no rain | |
| ROVENICH | 16 XII 18 | | The Batt continued the March to day at 8.00 a.m. Route – ROGGENDORF – KOMMERN – SCHWERFEN – SINZENICH – ZULPICH – ROVENICH. Billets were reached at 11.50 A.M. Distance 10½ miles. Weather good. The country passed through was very flat. | |

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1st Bn. Irish Guards

# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(5)

Army Form C. 2118.

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| HURTH | 17 XII 18 | | The Batt continued the March at 9.10 a.m. to day. Route - RODENICH - WEILER - ERP - LECHENICH - LIBLAR - HURTH. Billets were reached at 2 p.m. Distance 15 MILES. The weather broke just as the Batt were within a mile of Billets, a very heavy shower of rain & hail which drenched them. Roads good. As the Batt turned off the main road to HURTH the Rhine was seen in the distance. | GERMANY 2 L 1 100,000 |
| LOVENICH | 18 XII 18 | | The March was continued at 9 a.m. to day. Route - HURTH - HERMULHEIM - LIND - KLOSTER - LOVENICH. Billets were reached at 11.45 a.m. Distance 8 miles. Rain fell for the last two miles of the March. Billets very good. The Batt has now marched 92 miles in 8 days, hardly over very bad roads and mountainous country. | GERMANY 1 L 1 100,000 |
| LOVENICH | 19 XII 18<br>20 XII 18<br>21 XII 18<br>22 XII 18 | | The Batt remained in very comfortable Billets. It was hoped that the Batt would remain here for the occupation; but it was decided otherwise. | |

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7th Irish Guards

# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(6)

Army Form C. 2118.

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| NIPPES NEAR KÖLN | 23 XII 18 | | The Batt concluded the march to day. The Batt parading at 2 p.m.<br>Route. LOVENICH. – AACHENER STRASSE – HOHENZOLLERN RING – HANSA RING – KREFELDER STRASSE – NIPPES<br>The Drums played BRIEN BORO in the Batt entered the HOHENZOLLERN RING<br>The Brigadier General watched the Batt march in. Photographs of the Batt were taken as the Batt entered KÖLN. Billets reached at 11.50 a.m. Weather bad. Billets very good. 1 and 2 Coys being in one school and Nos 3 & 4 Coys and the School. Batt Cookers being at the | GERMANY 2. L. 1 |
| NIPPES | 24 XII 18 | | The day was spent in cleaning up and inspecting Billets | |
| NIPPES | 25 XII 18 | | Mass at 8.45 a.m. at the Church. C. of E. Service was held at 9.45 a.m. at the Gymnasium of the school when No 1 & 2 Coys are billeted. Owing to the transport difficulties the Xmas Dinners were not able to be taken on Christmas Day. Dinners to day. | |

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1st Bn. Tank Corps

# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(*Erase heading not required.*)

Army Form C. 2118.

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| NIPPES | 26/XII/18 | | Boxing day was considered a holiday. An inter platoon competition for the Tug of War was held in the morning. No 2 Platoon beat No 1 by one pull. Owing to the arrival on the previous night of a lorry from Paris the men were able to have their Christmas Dinners today at 12.30 pm. The Commanding Officer went round Billets during the afternoon. | |
| NIPPES | 27/XII/18 | | The Battalion remained in Billets. Spit & polish, time and Parades and inspections under Company arrangements. | |
| NIPPES | 28/XII/18 | | Mass at 10.30 am C of E also at 10.30 am. | |
| NIPPES | 30/XII/18 | | The new programme was started today. Corrective & two hours drill and physical training and one hours education. A practice run covering ten was held in the afternoon. | |

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(10340) Wt W3300/P715 750,000 3/18 E 688 Forms/C2118/16

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1st Irish Guards

# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

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Army Form C. 2118.

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| IPPES | 21 to 17 | | The Battn spent the morning at THE NIPPES Resuming 2 Bath. | |
| | | | Remarks on 4th March | |
| | | | The Battn marched into Worth 2.15 pm. Part of the 4th March on the way they very kindly put on lunches which the men thoroughly enjoyed after the long march. Upon arrival at Worth the Battn was billeted in the Town. The men on this occasion only received 1 blanket per man. It must be remembered that the Condition of the roads and the weather prevailed throughout the whole of the march were such that the men required 2 blankets per man. The men behaved splendidly throughout the march and their conduct has been excellent in every respect | |
| | | | Lt Col Commanding 1st Bn. Irish Guards | |

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(14)

# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
*(Erase heading not required.)*

1st Bn Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118.

(1)

January 1919.

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| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| NIPPES | 1/19 | | The Battn remained in Billets. Spending the time in Drill, Inspection and Bayonet Fighting and Physical Training. Also in organising the school buildings and making arrangements to make the Battn as comfortable as possible with a view to a long tour of duty in KÖLN. | |
| [KÖLN] | 2/19 | | | |
| | 3/19 | | | |
| | 4/19 | | | |
| | 5/19 | | Mass at 10.30 hours in the NIPPES CHURCH Church of England Service at 09.45 hours in the Gymnasium. The Battn provided a Guard of two Platoons from 2nd Bde under 2nd Lieut A.C HUTCHINSON MC and 2nd LIEUT E.C. FITZCLARENCE for a weeks duty at the GERMAN ARTILLERY DUMP at NIPPES SIDING. | |
| | 6/19 | | A new programme of work came into force this morning. Also the new scheme of Education was started with a Compulsory Educational Hour in the morning and voluntary classes in the evening. No work is to be done in the afternoon but men are to be encouraged to play games as much as possible. On Thursdays of Each week the Battn will march thro KÖLN to the Bridges over the RHINE | |

A5092. Wt. W128/9/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D & L. Ltd. Forms/C2118/14.

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(*Erase heading not required.*)

Army Form C. 2118.

(2)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Programme of work for week ending January 11th 1919. | |
| NIPPES [KÖLN] | 6/1/19 | | MONDAY 09-09.45 Drill; 10-10.45 {2 Coys Physical Drill & Bayonet Fighting; 2 Coys Musketry Theory for Instruction}; 11-12 Education | |
| | 7/1/19 | | Tuesday — Baths 2. Coys one hour Education before Baths 2 Coys one hour Education after Baths | |
| | 8/1/19 | | Wednesday Drill 2 Coys Physical Drill and Bayonet Fighting; 2 Coys Musketry Theory for Instruction EDUCATION | |
| | 9/1/19 | | Thursday — ROUTE MARCH. Time of Parade 09.00 hours — | |
| | 10/1/19 | | Friday Drill PHYSICAL DRILL and BAYONET Fighting EDUCATION | |
| | 11/1/19 | | Saturday INSPECTION by C.O of BARRACKS EDUCATION Scheme for officers | |
| | 8/1/19 | | Tuesday. At 1730 hours on 8/1/19 Nos 3 & 4 Coys paraded and lined the streets round Billets for the reception of The Colours which were brought from England by the colour party | |

A7092 Wt. W126.9/M1293 750,000. 1/17. D. D & L. Ltd. Forms/C2118/14.

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## JOINED.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 2/Lt. | J.L.D. Leidig, | 5. 1. 19. |
| " | A.G.St.P. Harris, | " |
| " | F.C. Baggalay, | " |
| " | P.H. Fitzgerald, | " |
| " | F.W. Burke, | " |
| " | R.E. Satchwell, | " |

STRENGTH ON 1. 1. 19:

| Officers. | Other Ranks. |
|---|---|
| 22 | 706 |

## LEFT.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Lt. | H.E. Van der Noot, | Demob. 20/1/19 |
| " | D.A.B. Moodie, M.C. | " 27/1/19 |
| Capt. | D.S. Browne, | " 30/1/19 |
| 2/Lt. | F.W. Burke, | To Gds' M.G. Regt. 16/1/19 |

STRENGTH ON 31. 1. 19:

| Officers. | Other Ranks. |
|---|---|
| 24 | 628 |

| | Officers. | Other Ranks. |
|---|---|---|
| Killed: | Nil. | Nil. |
| Wounded: | " | " |
| Missing: | " | " |

ORDERLY ROOM
No.
1 FEB. 1919
1ST BN IRISH GUARDS.

D.W. Gunston
Major for *Lieut. Colonel,*
*Commanding 1st Bn Irish Guards.*

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(3)

Army Form C. 2118.

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(*Erase heading not required.*)

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| NIPPES | | | Consisting of LIEUT D A B MOODIE M.C. 2nd LIEUT G.M TYLDESLEY WRIGHT. No 3227 Sgt BURDEN 3079 Sgt GROGAN and 3472 Sgt FLEMING. The Column arrived at 14.00 hours | |
| KÖLN | 12/1/19 | | SUNDAY. Mass at 10.30 hours in the NIPPES CHURCH C of E 10.00 hours<br>09-9.45 hours 10-10.30 hours 11-12 | |
| | 13/1/19 | | MONDAY.<br>Drill { 2 Coys Physical Drill & Bayonet Fighting<br>2 Coys Musketry Instruction & Lewis Gun Instruction } EDUCATION | |
| | 14/1/19 | | TUESDAY. Presentation of a UNION COLOUR by H.R.H The PRINCE OF WALES to the 2nd Bn The Kings Liverpool Regt. The 1st Bn had a holiday to enable them to attend the ceremony. In the afternoon the 1st Bn had a football match in which the 2nd Bn were victorious | |
| | 15/1/19 | | WEDNESDAY<br>Drill { 2 Coys Physical Drill & Bayonet Fighting<br>2 Coys Musketry & Lewis Gun Instruction } EDUCATION | |
| | 16/1/19 | | THURSDAY.<br>ROUTE MARCH Time of Parade 09.00 hours | |

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(18340) Wt.W5300/P713 750,000 3/18 E 688 Forms/C2118/16

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
*(Erase heading not required.)*

(4)

Army Form C. 2118.

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 0900-0945 1000-1030 1100-1200 | |
| NIPPES | 17/1/19 | | Friday Drill Physical Drill & Bayonet Fighting EDUCATION | |
| [KOLN] | 18/1/19 | | Saturday INSPECTION OF BARRACKS by C.O LECTURE by Capt Rae attached 2nd Batt Australia | |
| | 19/1/19 | | Sunday Mass 10.30 Lewis at NIPPES CHURCH C of E Service 09.45 Lewis | |
| | | | The Batt provided 70 OR under 2nd Lieuts G. LLEIDIA & 2nd LIEUT RS. BAGGHENT for a GUARD on the GERMAN ARTILLERY DUMP at NIPPES SIDING. The GUARD to dismount on the 27.1.19. | |
| | 20/1/19 | | Monday Drill { 2 Coys Physical Training & Bayonet Fighting EDUCATION 2 Coys Lewis gun & musketry instruction | |
| | 21/1/19 | | Tuesday Batts LECTURE at SCHILLER Gymnasium to all officers of the 1st Guard Brigade & 150 OR of each Batt in the Brigade by Major Fox D.S.O. SCOTS GUARDS on "The experiences of a Prisoner of War in GERMAN hands" | |

(19175) Wt W2358/P560 600,000 12/17 D. D. & L. Sch 53a. Forms/C2118/13

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

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Army Form C. 2118.

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | 0900 - 0945 | 10-1130 | 11-12 |
| NIBBES | 22/9 | | Wednesday, Drill { 2 Coys Physical Drill & Bayonet Fighting / 2 Coys Lewis Gun & Musketry Instruction | EDUCATION |
| [KÖLN] | 23/9 | | Thursday ROUTE MARCH Both paraded at 09.30 hours | |
| | 24/9 | | Friday Drill Physical Drill & Bayonet Fighting | EDUCATION |
| | 25/9 | | Saturday INSPECTION OF BILLETS by O.C. | EDUCATION |
| | 26/9 | | Sunday Mass at 10.30 hrs Cpl [illegible] | |
| | 27/9 | | Monday Drill { 2 Coys Physical Drill & Bayonet Fighting / 2 Coys Lewis Gun & Musketry Instruction } | EDUCATION |
| | 28/9 | | Tuesday Both Parties to SCHILLER GYMNASIUM by 15.00 hrs for Lecture. Both Parties Paraded by Companies by [illegible] | |
| | 29/9 | | Wednesday Drill { 2 Coys Physical Drill & Bayonet Fighting / 2 Coys Lewis Gun & Musketry Instruction } | EDUCATION |

(A9175) Wt W2358/P360 600,000 12/7 D. D. & L. Sch 81a. Forms/C2118/13

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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# WAR DIARY
*or*
# INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(*Erase heading not required.*)

Army Form C. 2118.

| Place | Date | Hour | Summary of Events and Information | Remarks and references to Appendices |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| WIPPES | 30th | | Thursday ROUTE March Built Parades at 09.00 Lms | |
| [KÖLN] | 31st | | Friday 09 0900 hrs Drill 10-12.30 Physical Drill & Bayonet fighting Work 1400 hrs | |
| | | | by The Rev Colonel The Rev J. H. MILLER CF NAPOLEON | |

Rowe-Baggallay
Lieut. Col.
Cmdg 1st Bn Irish Guards.

(59175) Wt W2358/P360 600,000 11/17 D. D. & L. Sch. 52a. Forms/C2118/5